

Help

Content in this section is designed to help advisors make sense of the Advisor-e app, provides suggestions for client case study via the advisory playsheets, offers quick learning pathways via the Quickfire Advisory Directory, and makes it easy to find feature tutorial videos. This content is suitable for new and experienced advisors alike and is NOT designed to be shared with clients directly but rather, act as learning guides.

Client On-Boarding

The following summary relates to content stored in the Client On-Boarding section of Advisor-e. This content is designed to help advisors secure advisory engagements with new and existing clients. This content is suitable for new and experienced advisors.

1. 1st Response Email - Advisor focused

- Benefits: This template establishes a structured, "Agile Theory" project management approach right from the initial inquiry. It breaks the engagement into Feasibility, Planning, and Implementation stages.
- How it helps the business owner: It reduces the business owner's risk and upfront costs by using a metaphor of "assessing structural integrity" before committing to final budgets, ensuring they only pay for a targeted feasibility stage initially.
- How it helps the advisor: It helps the advisor qualify prospects and secure an upfront fee (e.g., \$5,000 + GST) for the initial discovery and feasibility work, rather than doing this work for free. It also sets clear expectations for the client's time commitment (e.g., 5 hours and 3 meetings).
- Who it is suitable for: Advisors or consultants responding to a prospect's initial tender, project inquiry, or request for time.

2. **Advisory Pricing Model - Advisor focused**

- Benefits: This comprehensive spreadsheet template provides a modular pricing and scoping framework for a wide variety of advisory services, ranging from strategic planning and marketing reviews to detailed M&A due diligence.
- How it helps the business owner: It provides the client with extreme transparency, showing exactly what objectives are being tackled, the number of meetings, and the specific time and value allocated to each component of their business development.
- How it helps the advisor: It allows the firm to calculate profitable pricing by assigning specific hourly rates to different team members and tracking travel, prep, and advisory time. It also includes a robust scoping model to ensure complex jobs, like due diligence, are sequenced and costed thoroughly.
- Who it is suitable for: Accounting and advisory firms that need to standardize their pricing structure, delegate tasks to a team, and scope complex multi-stage consulting projects.

3. **Advisory Proposal - Advisor focused**

- Benefits: This slide deck template visually and logically structures a service pitch following a discovery meeting.
- How it helps the business owner: It clearly links the owner's desired "Milestones" and goals with their specific "Legitimate Constraints" (what is holding them back), ensuring they feel heard and understood. It also breaks down the investment into manageable monthly payments.
- How it helps the advisor: It creates a professional, persuasive narrative that guides the prospect from their problems to the advisor's recommended solutions and required investment. It also includes a standardized "Variation to Scope of Works" to cleanly handle future out-of-scope requests.
- Who it is suitable for: Advisors presenting a formal plan of attack and fee structure to a prospect after an initial discovery session.

4. **Get. TCM.Quiz Link Email - Advisor Focused**

- Benefits: A brief, low-friction communication designed to generate immediate client engagement.
- How it helps the business owner: It respects their time by taking less than 3 minutes to complete on a smartphone and helps them immediately focus on what needs attention in their business over the next 90 days.
- How it helps the advisor: It acts as a quick lead-generation or diagnostic tool, allowing the advisor to collect preliminary data and follow up with highly targeted guidance.

- Who it is suitable for: Advisors looking to re-engage their existing client base or warm up prospects with a simple interactive assessment.

5. Get. 5 Layers Questionnaire - Advisor Focused

- Benefits: An extensive, color-coded diagnostic tool (Green, Yellow, Orange, Red, Grey) that covers the entire business lifecycle from launch to maturity and exit.
- How it helps the business owner: It prompts deep critical thinking, asking the owner to evaluate their financial models, marketing awareness, team functionality, risk management, and succession plans, helping them identify operational blind spots.
- How it helps the advisor: It provides a structured agenda for a discovery meeting (focused on identifying problems, not immediate solutions). By the end of the questionnaire, the advisor has a clear understanding of the client's readiness, budget, and timeline to begin a business development program.
- Who it is suitable for: Advisors conducting deep-dive strategic planning sessions or formal discovery meetings to uncover wide-ranging business issues.

6. Get. Invitation Email - Advisor Focused

- Benefits: Provides three different tonal options (Enthusiastic, Conservative, and a "Mental Gym" metaphor) for inviting clients to a cloud-based business improvement portal.
- How it helps the business owner: It clearly explains the value of the new portal (24/7 access, centralized meeting notes, action plans, and problem-solving templates) and provides simple, step-by-step registration instructions.
- How it helps the advisor: It streamlines the onboarding process for new tech tools, frames the portal as a high-value service, and includes automated steps (like unlocking resources only after the client registers) to drive client compliance.
- Who it is suitable for: Firms rolling out a new client-facing software platform or business improvement portal and needing to drive user adoption.

7. New Client Details Form - Advisor Focused

- Benefits: A standardized administrative document to capture structural, contact, and financial information.
- How it helps the business owner: Ensures all of their primary and additional trading entities, shareholding splits, and preferred income types (salary, PAYE, drawings) are documented accurately for compliance and billing.
- How it helps the advisor: Centralizes critical onboarding data, preventing administrative errors and ensuring the firm has all necessary tax numbers, billing addresses, and digital profiles (website, Facebook) on file.

- Who it is suitable for: Administrative staff and advisors formally onboarding a new business client.

8. Schedule Based Pricing - Advisor Focused

- Benefits: Provides a framework and presentation to explain workload management, priority service fees, and necessary fee increases.
- How it helps the business owner: It gives them the option to pay a "Priority Schedule Fee" to jump the queue if they have urgent deadlines (like bank covenants or trust payments), treating it like "business class" priority baggage.
- How it helps the advisor: It allows the firm to smooth out their 12-month compliance workload by categorizing clients, monetizing rush jobs to cover staff overtime, and provides a scripted email template to justify fee increases using logical reasons (cost of living, compliance intensity).
- Who it is suitable for: Accounting firms facing seasonal bottlenecks, needing to implement priority pricing, or preparing to communicate a price hike to their client base.

End of Year Content

The following summary relates to content stored in the EOY (End of Year) Notes & Docs section of Advisor-e. This content is designed to help advisors secure advisory engagements with new and existing clients. This content is suitable for new and experienced advisors.

Agenda & Notes

Benefits:

- For the Business Owner: Keeps meetings highly focused on actionable outcomes, reviews progress chronologically, and provides a clear record of personal takeaways.
- For the Advisor: Provides a structured, repeatable flow that tracks time allocations and prompts the review of specific financial KPIs to maintain accountability.
- Suitable For: Standard coaching or advisory meetings requiring task follow-up and basic performance reviews.

How to Use in Practice:

1. Define the Structure: Fill out the date and the specific topics planned for the meeting, allocating fixed timeframes (e.g., 20 mins) to each.
2. Review Progress: Check task status using the Action Plan, explicitly reviewing financial performance/KPIs.
3. Qualitative Assessment: Ask the client to identify "What's Gone Less Well?" followed by "What's Gone Well?" to balance the operational review.
4. Conclude: Have the client state their top 3 key "Take-Aways" from the session to ensure mutual understanding.

Common Q&A:

1. What is the primary purpose of this template? To outline what is planned for the meeting and allocate specific timeframes to keep the session on track.
2. How is past progress reviewed? By checking task status on the Action Plan.
3. What specific numerical items are checked? Financial Performance and KPI's.
4. What qualitative questions are asked? The advisor prompts the client with "What's Gone Less Well?" and "What's Gone Well?".
5. What is the final step of the meeting? Documenting the top 3 key 'take-aways' specifically for the client.

Annual Management Plan

Benefits:

- For the Business Owner: Provides a macro, 12-month strategic view of the business, ensuring critical governance and planning topics are not missed.
- For the Advisor: Creates a predictable timeline for when specific reports (e.g., Global Business Trends, Budgets) must be prepared and analyzed.
- Suitable For: Boards of directors, executive teams, or larger businesses with structured governance and management needs.

How to Use in Practice:

1. Schedule the Calendar: Assign meeting dates and venues for every month of the year (e.g., "Friday 22nd").
2. Assign Strategic Items: Place major governance topics in their designated months (e.g., CEO Performance Review in May, Annual General Meeting in November).

3. Prepare Board Packs: Note down the required reports for each session (e.g., preparing the Capital Expenditure Estimates for April's Budget meeting).

Common Q&A:

1. What is the timeframe covered by this plan? The 2025 calendar year.
2. When does strategic scenario planning occur? February.
3. What specific reports are required in March? The Product Manager Report, Sales Manager Report, and Marketing Manager Report.
4. When is the Annual Financial Performance Review? June.
5. What happens in December? Directors Induction.

BO Expectations

Benefits:

- For the Business Owner: Translates personal lifestyle goals (income, weekly hours, annual leave) directly into business operational targets.
- For the Advisor: Maps out multi-stage business development goals (Stages 1-3) while calculating complex debt-to-equity ratios and loan amortizations.
- Suitable For: Business owners seeking to align their personal wealth and lifestyle milestones with their company's scaling phases.

How to Use in Practice:

1. Set Lifestyle Benchmarks: Input current (2025) income, weekly hours, and leave, then project Targets for Stage 1 (2026), Stage 2 (2029), and Stage 3 (2031).
2. Allocate Time: Break down the percentage of weekly hours spent on specific tasks (Strategic Client Dealings, Technician Duties, Fishing, etc.) and shift those percentages to achieve future focuses.
3. Calculate Business Stages: Input revenue, variable costs, fixed costs, and debt to automatically calculate required Net Profit and Debt/Equity percentages for each stage.
4. Run Debt Amortization: Use the "Interest Calculation Worksheet" to input purchase price, loan term, and interest rate to compare Table vs. Reducing repayments.

Common Q&A:

1. How many target income stages are modeled? Three target stages (2026, 2029, and 2031).

2. What does the task allocation measure? The percentage and exact hours spent on duties like strategic client dealings, team management, and technician duties.
3. What financial metrics are tracked in the business development stages? Revenue, variable costs (COGS), gross profit, fixed costs, net profit, and debt-to-equity percentages.
4. How does the template handle loan calculations? It includes an interest calculation worksheet side-by-side for Table and Reducing monthly repayments.
5. What specific leisure metrics are tied to the income goals? Weekly working hours and weeks of annual leave.

Basic Targets

Benefits:

- For the Business Owner: Simplifies financial jargon into core management fundamentals and highly relevant KPIs to track business health.
- For the Advisor: Provides a framework to guide clients through ratio analysis and effectively design a customized management dashboard.
- Suitable For: Clients who need to transition from emotional decision-making to data-driven business management.

How to Use in Practice:

1. Define Expectations & Stages: Confirm the business owner's expectations and development stages to establish baseline goals.
2. Review the 5 Fundamentals: Ensure the client understands the management cycle: Compilation, Assimilation, Interpretation, Application, and Observation.
3. Select Ratios: Walk through common ratios (Current, Quick, Debt to worth, Gross Margin, Net Margin, Return on Assets/Investment) and calculate them.
4. Test and Build KPIs: Test KPIs by asking if knowing the answer will actually help future decision-making, then design the client's dashboard.

Common Q&A:

1. What are the 5 management fundamentals? Compilation/Verification, Assimilation, Interpretation, Application, and Observation.
2. What does the 'Quick (working capital) Position' measure? Liquidity; specifically, the ratio of cash on hand and debtors to pay current liabilities.

3. How should KPIs conceptually be viewed? As measuring the business in three pieces (Getting Organised, Getting the Work, Doing the Work) consisting of inputs and outputs.
4. What is the primary test for deciding to track a KPI? Asking: "...if we knew the answer to X, how would that help us in our future decision making?".
5. What elements constitute the Working Capital Cycle? Cash, Stock, Sale, and Debtors.

EOY Meeting Agenda

Benefits:

- For the Business Owner: Visually maps where they are in their lifecycle via the Growth Curve and addresses current cash flow instability.
- For the Advisor: A structured end-of-year process that links draft account reviews directly to tactical behavior changes (Start, Stop, Keep).
- Suitable For: Standard business clients requiring an annual strategic and financial review.

How to Use in Practice:

1. Accounts Review: Summarise draft accounts, highlight concerns, and review the tax position and shareholder loan adjustments.
2. Assess Growth: Present the 9 Stages of Business Growth (Launch, Lifestyle, Leapfrog, etc.) to establish macro vision.
3. Analyze Volatility: Determine if current business issues are caused by Common, Special, Seasonal, or Tampering factors.
4. Address the Wobbles: Review products, admin procedures, marketing, and working capital to solve the volatility.
5. Assign Actions: Fill out the Start, Stop, Keep matrix to change operational behaviors.

Common Q&A:

1. What are the main segments of the agenda timeline? Review Accts, Review Growth Curve, Review Volatility, Start/Stop/Keep, and Q&A.
2. What must be discussed during the Accounts Review? Draft accounts, observations/concerns, tax position, shareholder loans, and Trustees Act current accounts.
3. How many stages are presented in the Growth Curve? 9 Growth Stages.
4. What analogy is used to explain volatility? "The faster you go, the bigger the mess..." depicted by a vehicle and caravan crashing.

5. What are the four categorizations of volatility cause? Common Cause, Special Cause, Seasonal, and Tampering (Data Misinterpretation).

EOY Meeting V2

Benefits:

- For the Business Owner: Shifts focus away from instability and toward forecasting scaling limits and potential income pipelines.
- For the Advisor: Provides a platform to analyze sales pipelines and operational capacity to ground client expectations in reality.
- Suitable For: High-growth businesses where scaling and revenue capacity are the primary bottlenecks, rather than basic cash volatility.

How to Use in Practice:

1. Accounts Review: Conduct standard end-of-year compliance discussions regarding accounts, taxes, and loan adjustments.
2. Locate on Growth Curve: Review the 9-stage growth curve to identify the business's current lifecycle position.
3. Explore Revenue Capacity: Replace the volatility exercise by assessing revenue capacity, specifically separating "Possibility" from "Probability" in the sales model.
4. Draft Action Plans: Conclude by documenting new operational rules in the Start, Stop, Keep matrix.

Common Q&A:

1. How does this agenda differ from the standard EOY agenda? It replaces the "Review Volatility" segment with a "Revenue Model" segment.
2. What is the core focus of the revenue section? Exploring Revenue Capacity.
3. What psychological/analytical concept is applied to revenue? Separating Possibility From Probability.
4. What visual aid is used to discuss revenue capacity? An image of two partially filled glasses with green liquid.
5. Does this version still include an accountability step? Yes, it retains the Start, Stop, Keep exercise for recording future actions.

EOY Rural Meeting

Benefits:

- For the Business Owner (Farmer): Aligns strategic planning with familiar agricultural milestones and helps structure high-capital spending plans (like equipment or herd homes).
- For the Advisor: Translates standard corporate advisory tools into rural terminology to better connect with farming clients.
- Suitable For: Agricultural clients, sharemilkers, farm owners, and rural enterprises.

How to Use in Practice:

1. Rural Accounts: Summarise draft accounts, highlighting tax positioning and any trust-related current accounts.
2. Plot the Farmer's Curve: Identify the client's current and desired position on the 8-stage Farmer's Growth Position chart (e.g., moving from Herd Manager to Sharemilker).
3. Forecast Probability: Discuss rural volatility (weather, payouts) as a means of forecasting probability rather than just tracking past wobbles.
4. Build Spending Plan: Chart a 5-year Strategic Spending Plan, categorizing purchases into Lifestyle, Operational, and Strategic timeframes.

Common Q&A:

1. What replaces the standard 9-stage growth curve in this template? The 8-stage Farmer's Growth Position.
2. What is the starting position on the rural growth curve? Labourer.
3. What is the ultimate top position on the rural growth curve? Vertical/Consortium Owner.
4. What specific financial tool is introduced for capital purchases? The 5 yr Strategic Spending Plan.
5. What are the three categories in the Strategic Spending Plan? Lifestyle (e.g., New Boat), Operational (e.g., New Tractor), and Strategic (e.g., Herd Home).

EOY Scripts Only

Benefits:

- For the Business Owner: Experiences a highly professional, smoothly transitioning meeting where they are mentally prepared to accept advice.

- For the Advisor: Provides specific psych-linguistic framing to take control of meetings and effectively manage difficult or hostile client personas.
- Suitable For: Advisors preparing for high-stakes, emotionally charged, or conceptually difficult annual client meetings.

How to Use in Practice:

1. Frame the Meeting: Open with "How're you going for time today?" to bridge to the business zone, assume permission ("If it's o-k with you..."), take control of the agenda, and close the psychological loop ("How does that sound?").
2. Role Play Preparations: Rehearse body posture, pacing, and tone matching for specific client scenarios (e.g., Angry, Depressed, Withdrawn).
3. Introduce the Curve via Persona: When explaining the Growth Curve, speak in the 3rd person (e.g., "Bob the Chocolate maker") to create dissociation so the client doesn't feel personally attacked.
4. Address Volatility: Frame cash flow issues using the analogy of a towing vehicle getting "speed wobbles", explaining that growth cannot happen until balance is restored.

Common Q&A:

1. What is the purpose of the initial framing questions? To smoothly bridge the client from the 'Personal Zone' to the 'Business Zone' and assume psychological control of the meeting.
2. How should an advisor physically handle an extremely withdrawn client? Fill up the 'theatre' with energy and use expansive body movements to assist.
3. Why use a persona ("Bob the Chocolate maker") when revealing the Growth Curve? To talk in the 3rd person and create a psychological dissociation for the client.
4. What specific physical analogy is used to explain volatility to a client? Driving a vehicle with a trailer/caravan that gets 'speed wobbles'.
5. What happens to a business if volatility isn't addressed before growth? The leading vehicle (business) gets dragged from side to side and cannot progress safely.
6. How do you handle an "Angry & Rude Guy" (Mr Prickly)? Stay 'high level', do not react immediately, and use the 'By the way' phrasing to discover the root of the anger.

SMART & FAST Goals

Benefits:

- For the Business Owner: Reconnects them to their fundamental life desires and ensures their goals become deeply ingrained beliefs rather than passing daydreams.
- For the Advisor: Provides a psychological toolkit to challenge client limits and drive intense motivation through comprehensive time-framing.
- Suitable For: Clients lacking motivation, those undergoing strategic resets, or individuals struggling to execute operational tasks.

How to Use in Practice:

1. Set the Rules: Establish the session objective: the advisor's role is to challenge beliefs, and the client's role is to have an open mind.
2. Explain the SMART Methodology: Define Specific, Measurable, Affect, Relative, and Timebound. Pay special attention to "Affect" (direct influence and emotional connection).
3. Brainstorming Phase: Have the client turn off distractions and brainstorm desires across 10 categories (Financial, Relationships, Spiritual, etc.) without putting any limits on themselves.
4. Allocate Time Frames: Categorize all brainstormed goals from A (Immediate) to J (5 yrs +).
5. Rewrite and Execute: Write the goals out chronologically by timeframe and place them somewhere visible to breed success.

Common Q&A:

1. What is the advisor's primary role in this session? To "Challenge What You Believe To Be True!".
2. What does the "A" in this version of SMART stand for? Affect, meaning you must be able to directly influence success and have a strong emotional connection.
3. What historical practice is the 'Affect' component tied to? Mesmerism (hypnosis), referencing Abbe Fera's work on how the subconscious responds to suggestions.
4. What is the role of the ego in goal setting? To perform the "reality function," identifying fantasy from reality.
5. How should clients begin drafting their actual goals? By allowing themselves an hour to dream and feel good, imagining they have superpowers with no limits.

Personal Budget:

Benefits:

- For the Business Owner: Gives a comprehensive breakdown of actual living costs and visualizes true cash flow after statutory deductions.
- For the Advisor: Prevents the client from draining business working capital by determining the exact, realistic drawings required to fund their personal life.
- Suitable For: Individual owners, couples, or anyone needing to calculate their survival and discretionary cash requirements.

How to Use in Practice:

1. Calculate Gross to Net: Input the gross annual income and superannuation deduction percentages for the earners (e.g., Bill and Mary) to get the true net available.
2. Apply Tax Tables: Ensure the gross income filters through the Federal and State tax bands (ranging from 0% to 39%) to accurately reflect take-home pay.
3. Audit Expenditure: Systematically enter current spending frequency and amounts across specific categories: Accommodation, Basic living, Children, Car, Financial, Medical, and Discretionary.
4. Review Bottom Line: Analyze the resulting Annual and Monthly Surplus (or deficit) to adjust future drawings or cut spending.

Common Q&A:

1. What does the "Pay Day" to Annual Calculator do? It converts gross income based on payment frequency (e.g., Weekly, Monthly).
2. How is true net income calculated in the tool? By subtracting superannuation deductions and automatically factoring state and federal tax brackets.
3. What are the primary expense categories audited? Accommodation, Basic living costs, Children/education, Car/vehicle, Financial, Medical, and Discretionary.
4. What is the final performance metric of the budget? Annual and Mthly Surplus (deficit).
5. Are allowances made for future savings or debt? Yes, it includes lines like "Car Finance/Savings Allowance" and "Investment / savings".

Volatility Exceptions

Benefits:

- For the Business Owner: Prevents panic or misdirected strategic shifts when normal, structural cash swings occur.
- For the Advisor: Acts as a vital contextual safeguard, ensuring data isn't misinterpreted (Tampering) when standard business rules don't apply.

- Suitable For: Agricultural co-op suppliers, government-funded centers, and event-based enterprises.

How to Use in Practice:

1. Assess Business Structure: Before presenting standard volatility metrics, check the client's core revenue mechanism.
2. Identify Exceptions: Look for semi-regular government subsidies, co-operative yield limits, or massive singular seasonal events.
3. Modify the Meeting: If the business falls into these categories, DO NOT use the standard CASH volatility graph during the EOY review.

Common Q&A:

1. What is the primary purpose of this specific document? To outline exactly when NOT to use the CASH Volatility Graph with clients.
2. What is the first exception listed? Businesses that receive Government subsidy payments on a semi-regular basis.
3. Give an example of a subsidy-based exception. A child care centre.
4. What is the second exception? Businesses that supply a co-operative or vertical distributor that sets price or yield limits.
5. What is the third exception? Businesses with a known, singular, high-impact seasonal event, such as a concert promoter.

EOY Quiz Questions

- Purpose: A brief questionnaire template designed to test the client's knowledge of fundamental business metrics, such as customer acquisition costs, variable vs. fixed costs, and shareholder loan accounts.
- How it helps the business owner: It forces them to reflect on their financial literacy and highlights specific blind spots in their understanding of their own business costs.
- How it helps the advisor: It quickly identifies gaps in the client's financial knowledge, allowing the advisor to tailor the upcoming meeting to those specific educational needs.
- Indicators for use: The client struggles with pricing, cash flow, or understanding their fixed vs. variable costs, or the advisor wants a quick assessment of a new prospect's financial acumen.

Growth Fundamentals Framework

The following summary relates to content stored in the Growth Framework section of Advisor-e. This content is designed to help advisors secure advisory engagements with new and existing clients. This content is suitable for new and experienced advisors.

The Growth Fundamentals Framework provides a comprehensive roadmap for a company's evolution, beginning at the Design phase and progressing through nine distinct Growth Stages toward an eventual Exit or Decline. To successfully navigate this journey, the model identifies seven strategic tactics and nine core aspects, such as Process Improvement and Customer Focus, that must be managed simultaneously.

A significant portion of the material focuses on the psychological barriers and psyche errors—including confirmation bias and complacency—that can hinder a leader's progress during critical transitions. Specifically, the "Devil's Toilet" serves as a metaphor for the treacherous period between achieving a stable lifestyle and scaling for leverage, where fatigue often stalls momentum. By balancing financial levers with an awareness of complexity layers, business owners can better recognize their current position and prepare for the next tactical shift. Through this integrated approach, the framework aims to help entrepreneurs achieve sustainable expansion while avoiding common cognitive traps and operational plateaus.

The provided sources comprise four distinct presentation slide decks that collectively form the Growth Fundamentals Framework. Here is a review of these templates, outlining their core purpose, benefits, client indicators, and a summary table.

Purpose of the Templates

The templates are designed as a comprehensive framework to guide the thinking, observation, reflections, and actions of those striving for business excellence. They map the lifecycle of a business onto a 'Sigmoid-type/Sine Wave-type Curve' to illustrate the regenerative aspects of growth. The framework breaks business growth down into 9 Growth Stages (from Design to Exit/Decline), 7 Growth Focus Tactics, 5 Layers of Complexity (and associated Psyche Errors), and 9 Growth Aspects.

How it Helps the Business Owner

- Establishes Context: It helps owners recognize exactly where they currently sit on the growth curve based on where they have come from and where they are headed.

- Creates Self-Relevance & Motivation: By contextualizing their journey, it creates "Self Relevance," which is critical for learning and developing the motivation to act.
- Proactive Problem Solving: The framework highlights the types of issues owners can expect to encounter *before* they actually have to cope with them, ensuring they are better prepared to handle dangerous stages like the "Devil's Toilet" (profit plateaus).
- Identifies Roadblocks: It clearly defines "What Got You Here" versus "What Holds You Back" for each stage, helping owners see missing skill sets or psychological traps holding back their growth.

How it Helps the Advisor

- Structured Facilitation: It provides advisors with a step-by-step "Reveal Format" to draw the curve freehand in "3x3 chunks," allowing for measured, interactive discussions with clients.
- Improved Client Engagement: By utilizing storytelling and "personas" (e.g., "Bob the Chocolate maker"), the advisor can discuss concepts in the third person. This creates dissociation—avoiding judgment, reducing jargon, and helping the advisor overcome the stereotype of being a purely analytical or "boring" accountant.
- Scalable Service Delivery: The templates offer two distinct engagement models: a "Full" version (involving 3-5 meetings, upwards of 10 hours, aimed at complex businesses) and a "Lite" version (a focused 1-meeting engagement for smaller clients with lower fee tolerance).

Indicators That the Template is Appropriate for a Client

- Experiencing Stagnation or Fatigue: If a client is experiencing a "profit plateau" or extreme fatigue after putting in significant effort, they may be stuck in the "Devil's Toilet" and need the framework to navigate toward the "Leverage" stage.
- Exhibiting Psychological Roadblocks ("Psyche Errors"): If an owner is showing signs of *Confirmation Bias* (ignoring reality to maintain focus), *Complacency* (inability to focus on the external environment after reaching perceived security), or *Role Identification* (acting how they think a "Boss" should act rather than being authentic), the framework is highly applicable.
- Facing a Transition or "Split Point": Clients who are unsure whether to continue scaling or prepare for succession/exit can benefit from the framework's detailed breakdown of the "Maturity," "Leapfrog," and "Exit/Decline" stages.

Revenue & Feasibility Models

This section contains more than 74 industry specific revenue models. Each model is designed to help advisors gain 'granular insight' with new and existing clients as they build closer relations.

Using a collaborative revenue model is the vital first step in delivering advisory services because it clarifies the specific variables that contribute to a client's profit and calculates their true financial capacity. By comparing a client's current reality against their probable potential, advisors eliminate guesswork and provide the contextual awareness needed to relieve the owner's stress over unknown financial performance.

This strategic process allows advisors to clearly illustrate their business knowledge and effectively align with the client on critical assumptions, future visions, and personal expectations.

Ultimately, analyzing this performance gap secures client engagement and forms a clear, data-driven foundation for targeted business improvement plans

This content is suitable for new and experienced advisors alike. The content is primarily of an EDUCATION nature and therefore supports younger advisors or those looking to build confidence and skills in the advisory market.

General Tools

The following summary relates to content stored in the General section of Advisor-e. This content is designed to help advisors secure advisory engagements with new and existing clients. This content is suitable for new and experienced advisors. The content is primarily of an EDUCATION

nature and therefore, is better suited to younger advisors or those looking to build confidence and skills in the advisory market.

1. 6 Hats Thinking

- Purpose: To introduce a framework for collaborative "parallel thinking" over traditional "argument thinking," helping teams avoid confirmation bias and cross-purpose discussions.
- How it helps the business owner: It directs the minds of the team using a shared structure and language, ensuring everyone focuses on the same topic and views issues from multiple perspectives (creative, critical, emotional, etc.), which enhances problem-solving and innovation.
- How it helps the advisor: It increases the effectiveness of business planning sessions 10-fold by getting all participants focused and using the same terminology.
- Indicators for use: The client's team frequently experiences conflict, confusion, ego-clashes, or "trips over each other" during meetings.

2. 90 Day Accounting Best Practice Plan

- Purpose: A 90-day training program covering four key sessions (Coding, Transactions, Quality Control, and Close Off) to teach best practices for using financial software like Xero.
- How it helps the business owner: It prevents costly mistakes, "surprise" tax bills, and ensures the business's chart of accounts is aligned with what the owner actually wants to measure.
- How it helps the advisor: It creates a paid, structured engagement (\$1,500 - \$1,800) and prevents the advisor from having to untangle "birds-nest nightmares" caused by untrained staff.
- Indicators for use: The client's financial administrator is out of their depth, the accounts require constant clean-up, or the client needs actionable KPI reports rather than just tax data.

3. Dashboard Discussions

- Purpose: A framework for evaluating financial ratios (e.g., Sales to Gross Profit, Wages to Sales) by breaking down costs into Variable (Do the Job), Activity (Get the Job), and Fixed (Get Organised) categories.
- How it helps the business owner: It helps them identify the root causes of their financial data (Cause - Event - Effect) and determine which tactical options will have the greatest influence on their business.

- How it helps the advisor: It sets the advisor's role to "Challenge What You Believe To Be True," positioning them as a strategic partner who guides the client to look beyond just the numbers.
- Indicators for use: The client relies on assumptions instead of facts, struggles to interpret financial metrics, or needs help understanding how operational decisions impact profitability.

4. One Page Business Case

- Purpose: A condensed business case template designed to evaluate the viability of a new idea by assessing the "Big Idea", target customers, revenue models, and the "Acid Test" (key obstacles and risks).
- How it helps the business owner: It forces them to identify potential competitive advantages, infrastructure requirements, and a "Ripcord" strategy to collapse the business quickly if it fails.
- How it helps the advisor: It provides a rapid, structured way to assess a client's new venture without needing a 50-page business plan.
- Indicators for use: The client wants to launch a new product, pivot their service, or start a completely new business enterprise.

5. The 8 Profit Levers

- Purpose: To break down the components of profitability into 8 controllable levers: Foot-traffic, Prospects, Customers, Customer Spend, Customer Frequency, Sales Margin, Activity Costs, and Fixed Costs.
- How it helps the business owner: It visually demonstrates how small, incremental improvements across multiple levers (e.g., converting 20% of prospects instead of 8%) can lead to massive profit increases.
- How it helps the advisor: It transitions abstract financial goals into a concrete Action Plan where the advisor can assign specific tasks and deadlines to improve specific business functions.
- Indicators for use: The client wants to increase profits but doesn't know where to focus, or they are suffering from a "Profit Plateau".

6. Working Capital Cycle

- Purpose: To explain the flow of "Money in Movement" (Working Capital) versus "The cost of being in business" (Fixed Capital), highlighting how time delays affect cashflow.
- How it helps the business owner: It shows how delayed collection cycles (e.g., 60 days vs 30 days) drastically reduce stock turn and available cash, and demonstrates the danger of discounting prices.

- How it helps the advisor: It allows the advisor to model scenarios showing exactly how much working capital is needed to support growth, warning clients away from dangerous "over-trading" (funding growth primarily via debt).
- Indicators for use: The client is growing rapidly but running out of cash, considering discounting to win work, or using long-term debt to fund short-term stock cycles.

7. 4 Part Business Plan

- Purpose: A comprehensive planning tool combining Market Assumptions, Business Owner Expectations, an 8 Lever Action Plan, and a Revenue Model.
- How it helps the business owner: It aligns the business's growth stages with the owner's personal goals (e.g., desired income, weekly hours, weeks of annual leave) and clearly tracks business development over multiple years.
- How it helps the advisor: It secures long-term engagement by breaking growth into manageable stages (Stage 1, 2, 3) and mapping out the specific tasks required.
- Indicators for use: The client feels overworked (seeking "Ikigai" or purpose), wants to significantly scale up, or lacks a long-term strategic direction.

8. 3 Pillars of Financial Management

- Purpose: An educational template to provide practical steps for a business owner to learn financial management.
- How it helps the business owner: It breaks the process into actionable steps, starting with the 'math' of their own (business variable) assumptions via a suitable revenue model, then a systems review before suggesting they learn ratio analysis.
- How it helps the advisor: It secures long-term engagement by showing a progressive pathway to financial literacy - supported all the way by their trusted advisor.
- Indicators for use: The client fails to use financial management reports or seeks a cash forecast to support a funding application without knowledge of feasibility or ongoing performance reviews.

9. Debtor Protocols & Business Drag Model

- Purpose: Provides a step-by-step system, phone scripts, and communication templates (like the 'Lolly Letter') to recover outstanding debts, alongside a spreadsheet to model the financial "drag" of unpaid invoices.
- How it helps the business owner: It overcomes the psychological barriers (like role-identification and fear of confrontation) that stop owners from demanding payment, providing them with structured, polite, but firm methods to get their cash back.

- How it helps the advisor: It allows the advisor to implement immediate, tangible cash-flow improvements for the client, proving the value of the advisory relationship.
- Indicators for use: The client relies heavily on a few large customers who pay late, the person doing admin avoids calling debtors, or the client feels they have "no right" to demand payment.

10. Rubbish in - Rubbish Out

- Purpose: To establish clean financial data management by correctly organizing the Chart of Accounts into Variable, Activity, and Fixed costs (using a "Filing Cabinet" analogy).
- How it helps the business owner: It ensures they are gathering accurate data so they can measure the effects of major decisions (e.g., expanding premises or hiring) and know early enough if a decision was wrong.
- How it helps the advisor: It cleans up the client's books, allowing the advisor to generate accurate KPIs and measure what actually matters to the business's success.
- Indicators for use: The client cannot measure the impact of recent business changes, or their accounts are "jumbled up" and unhelpful for decision-making.

11. What's Applicable (Technology)

- Purpose: A review to identify where software and technology can be applied across business areas (Inbound, Outbound, Sales, Workflow, Inventory, etc.) to improve either efficiency or effectiveness.
- How it helps the business owner: It helps them identify repetitive, everyday tasks that can be automated without reducing their effectiveness with customers.
- How it helps the advisor: It provides a structured way to audit a client's operational software and recommend tools (like CRM, workflow management, or OCR receipt feeds).
- Indicators for use: The client's administration is heavily manual, they struggle to track job costing, or their sales engagement is unorganized.

12. The Customer Journey

- Purpose: To map out the "Revenue Story"—how customers find, trust, and buy from the business—tracking the journey from Total Available Market down to Lifetime Customer Value.
- How it helps the business owner: It helps identify exactly where the marketing or sales journey is "breaking down" and prompts them to address the specific frustrations or frictions stopping target profiles from purchasing.
- How it helps the advisor: It broadens the advisory scope into sales and marketing, allowing the advisor to help construct outbound messaging and product reviews.

- Indicators for use: The client has high exposure but few prospects, or lots of initial sales but no loyal customers or referrals.

13. Demings Volatility

- Purpose: Explains that calculating simple averages is flawed for predicting performance; introduces Standard Deviation to plot natural business volatility.
- How it helps the business owner: It establishes a "likely range" of performance, helping them avoid making knee-jerk decisions when sales naturally dip, or becoming complacent when sales naturally spike.
- How it helps the advisor: It provides a more sophisticated tool for forecasting and performance review, separating normal variation from actual business decline.
- Indicators for use: The client has a highly seasonal business, or frequently panics over month-to-month sales fluctuations.

14. Quick Fire Diagnosis

- Purpose: A rapid, 30-minute triage tool to determine if a business is in "Distress" or "Growth" mode, and to pinpoint the biggest problem areas across Getting Organised, Getting the Job, or Doing the Job.
- How it helps the business owner: It makes the problem-solving logic "visible", moving them out of denial or confusion and empowering them with a clear path forward (whether that is salvage, liquidation, or growth).
- How it helps the advisor: It acts as a diagnostic roadmap, telling the advisor exactly which templates (e.g., Quick Position, Revenue Model, Lite Fundamentals) to use based on the client's current crisis or goal.
- Indicators for use: The client states "I'm unhappy about our business performance" or "I'm worried we might go under," but doesn't know the specific root cause.

15. The HOPE Recession Model

- Purpose: To map the standard economic cycle and explain the sequence of an economic slowdown: Housing, Orders, Profits, Employment.
- How it helps the business owner: It forces them to consider macroeconomic threats and develop a Strategic Withdrawal Plan (e.g., identifying assets to sell or staff redundancies) before emotional distress sets in.
- How it helps the advisor: It positions the advisor as a critical sounding board for risk management and contingency planning.
- Indicators for use: The broader economy is facing inflation or rising interest rates, or the client operates in a highly cyclical industry with no defensive strategy.

16. KPI's

- Purpose: A selection menu of Financial and Non-Financial Key Performance Indicators (e.g., WIP Days, Customer Satisfaction, Return on Assets).
- How it helps the business owner: Allows them to intentionally choose what they want to "Pay Attention To" and ensure their software is tracking it accurately.
- How it helps the advisor: It helps build standardized management reporting dashboards tailored to the client's goals.
- Indicators for use: The client is not tracking their performance, or they are tracking vanity metrics instead of actionable data.

17. Lite Feasibility

- Purpose: A tool for assessing the payback, risk, and break-even requirements of a specific asset purchase or funding request.
- How it helps the business owner: Helps calculate the required utilization rate of new equipment and identify a "Ripcord" strategy (how to sell the asset if the venture fails).
- How it helps the advisor: Provides a quick framework to validate or challenge a client's capital expenditure plans before they commit financially.
- Indicators for use: The client wants to buy new machinery, expand operations, or take out a business loan.

18. People vs. Process

- Purpose: A diagnostic tool to determine if operational failures are due to the People (Do they Know, Do, and Care?) or the Process (Six Sigma, Lean, Constraint Theory).
- How it helps the business owner: It clarifies exactly where the bottleneck is, preventing them from unfairly blaming staff for a broken system, or trying to fix a system when staff lack basic skills or motivation.
- How it helps the advisor: It provides an objective framework to analyze operational efficiency and customer promise alignment.
- Indicators for use: The client complains about staff performance, quality control issues, or frequent production bottlenecks.

19. Price Rise

- Purpose: An educational template for business owners to provide (two) methods for communicating a price rise to their customers.
- How it helps the business owner: It allows them to develop scripts based on their own personality and customer relationship dynamics.
- How it helps the advisor: It introduces the methods and scripts are provided to 'get the ball rolling' but are most certainly intended to be revised to suit each owner.

- Indicators for use: The client fears putting their prices up and lacks a method of communicating their position to customers.

20. Business Structure Options

- Purpose: Reviews the primary legal structures (Sole Trader, Partnership, Company, Trust) and explains the concept of the "Corporate Veil" and separate legal entities.
- How it helps the business owner: Ensures they understand how to protect what they build, how liability works, and how their structure impacts their ability to sell the business in the future.
- How it helps the advisor: Allows the advisor to have a proactive conversation about asset protection, succession, and risk without giving formal legal advice.
- Indicators for use: The client is starting a new business, operating in a highly litigious industry, taking on a partner, or amassing significant working assets.

Lite Fundamentals

The following summary relates to content stored in the Lite Fundamentals section of Advisor-e. This content is designed to help advisors secure REGULAR advisory engagements with new and existing clients. The content is a combination of EDUCATION and FACILITATION and therefore, is better suited to advisors who have previous experience in running client meetings without supervision. In a nutshell, the lite fundamentals postulates that every business needs to practice the fundamentals to be successful over time. The Lite Fundamentals are a collection of business concepts that make up the 80/20 level of education required to allow a Mum and Dad or privately owned business to be profitable over time.

Lite Fundamentals Support Tools

Get.Invitation email

Benefits

- How it helps the business owner: It provides them with a 'cloud-based' business improvement portal that acts as a "mental gym" to access meeting agendas, action plans, and business improvement templates 24/7 from anywhere in the world.

- **How it helps the advisor:** It streamlines client onboarding, tests a new service delivery method, and creates an easy-to-find, centralized record of accountability (who was supposed to do what).
- **Who it may be suitable for:** Existing clients ready for business growth, conservative clients willing to participate in a "trial", or motivated business owners looking to solve problems and enjoy being in business.

How to use the material in practice

1. Select the appropriate email option based on your client's profile: the standard announcement, the conservative "trial" approach, or the "mental gym" approach.
2. Send the email containing the Advisor-e.com registration link.
3. Instruct the client to click the blue 'Finish Signing Up' button and create a memorable password.
4. Advise the client to click the "Client Service Plan (Yellow Button)" upon logging in to view recommended starting content.
5. If the client has not authenticated their login within 7 working days, send the provided follow-up email offering technical assistance to walk them through the process.

Common Q&A

1. **Q:** What is the main purpose of the portal mentioned in the emails? **A:** To host a comprehensive range of business improvement templates, record meeting agendas, and track automated action plan reminders.
2. **Q:** How does a user complete their registration? **A:** By clicking the link sent via email, clicking the 'Finish Signing Up' button, and entering a password.
3. **Q:** What should a user do if they cannot find their invitation email? **A:** Check their spam and junk folders for an email with "Advisor-e.com" on the banner.
4. **Q:** What is the first action a client should take once inside the portal? **A:** Click on the yellow Client Service Plan button to view recommended content.
5. **Q:** What is the follow-up procedure if the client experiences technical issues? **A:** The advisor sends a follow-up email offering a phone call to 'walk them through it'.

Get.Lite Sales Prompts

Benefits

- **How it helps the business owner:** Helps them visualize their business trajectory using the Growth Curve and clearly identifies the legitimate blockages holding their business back.

- **How it helps the advisor:** Provides a structured, low-pressure "SPIDER" framework to navigate a sales meeting, ensuring conditions are met before revealing the program.
- **Who it may be suitable for:** Advisors pitching the Lite Fundamentals program to prospects, particularly when they need a reliable conversational framework to secure a commitment.

How to use the material in practice

1. **Show your get-out-of-jail card early:** State clearly that the objective is just to share a concept and gain feedback, with no final decisions required today.
2. **Pin the tail on the donkey:** Show the Growth Curve framework and ask the client where they think their business currently sits, and where they would like it to be.
3. **Investigate blockages:** Ask questions to identify the legitimate constraints and weaknesses holding the business back.
4. **Determine/Dangle the prize:** Show the Revenue Model to demonstrate the potential financial improvement worth going for.
5. **Ensure conditions are agreed:** Clearly state the three requirements (time for regular meetings, commitment to action, and an agreed monthly fee).
6. **Reveal the golden key:** Show the 6 topics and dashboard report, then ask how they would like to move forward.

Common Q&A

1. **Q:** What does the acronym SPIDER stand for? **A:** Show, Pin, Investigate, Determine/Dangle, Ensure, Reveal.
2. **Q:** How should an advisor respond if a client says "No, I don't really think it's for me"? **A:** Reassure them it is no problem, it's not a reflection on either party, and offer to continue doing their normal accounts.
3. **Q:** What are the three requirements an advisor needs from a client to start the program? **A:** Time for regular meetings, full commitment to completing actions between meetings, and a regular monthly fee arrangement.
4. **Q:** How should an advisor practice this sales script? **A:** Block time in their diary, role-play with a buddy, or use a webcam to record facial expressions and tonality.
5. **Q:** What is the purpose of "showing your get out of jail card early"? **A:** To relieve pressure by telling the client that no final decisions have to be made today.

Growth Stage Detail

Benefits

- **How it helps the business owner:** Educates them on the 9 stages of business growth, validating their current struggles and preparing them for the challenges of the next level.
- **How it helps the advisor:** Equips the advisor with a diagnostic framework to understand what "got the client here" and "what holds them back", allowing for targeted consulting.
- **Who it may be suitable for:** Business owners at any stage of their journey—from conceptual design to exiting the business—who feel stuck and need a roadmap.

How to use the material in practice

1. Present the "9 Growth Stages" curve to the client (spanning from Design to Exit/Decline).
2. Identify the client's current stage by cross-referencing their situation with the "What Got You Here" descriptors (e.g., significant effort and focus on customer delivery places them in Break-Even).
3. Diagnose their immediate challenges by reviewing the "What Holds You Back" section for their specific stage (e.g., lack of financial management expertise in the Maturity stage).
4. Determine the next necessary "Growth Focus" (e.g., Growth through delegation, replication or quantification) to help them break through their current ceiling of complexity.
5. Review the 9 'Growth Aspects' (such as Process Improvement, Customer Focus, and Governance) to ensure the business remains balanced during growth.

Common Q&A

1. **Q:** What typically holds a business owner back in the "Launch" stage? **A:** Realisation of the task enormity, financial risks of failure, and legitimate timing or resource obstacles.
2. **Q:** What is the "Growth Focus" for a business in the "Leverage" stage? **A:** Growth through delegation, replication or quantification.
3. **Q:** What characterizes the "Maturity" stage of a business? **A:** The business commands a sizeable market-share and creates a 'barrier to entry' for competitors.
4. **Q:** What holds a business back in the "Exit / Decline" stage? **A:** Failure to have developed inherent value beyond the owner's personal involvement, and perhaps a lack of vision for 'life after business'.
5. **Q:** What are the 9 Growth Aspects that must be completed effectively at every stage? **A:** Process Improvement, Customer Focus, Sales, Authenticity, Inventory & Equipment, Team Focus, Innovation, Governance, and Harmony/Balance.

LF 1 Page Map - Global Map

Benefits

- **How it helps the business owner:** Provides a simple, one-page visual checklist of every operational and strategic area needed to align expectations, win business, and improve processes.
- **How it helps the advisor:** Serves as a highly structured tracking tool to monitor client progress across six core domains (Planning, Data, Marketing, Sales, People, Process) during engagements.
- **Who it may be suitable for:** Advisors and clients who need a high-level, structured roadmap to track the implementation of business fundamentals over time.

How to use the material in practice

1. Divide your consulting strategy into three pillars: Get Organised, Get the Job, and Do the Job.
2. Under "Get Organised", work through Planning (Aligning Owner Expectations) and Data (Knowing What Matters), addressing items like the Working Capital Cash Tactics.
3. Under "Get the Job", move through Marketing and Sales, completing tasks like the 1 Page Marketing Plan and Sales Design.
4. Under "Do the Job", focus on People and Process, addressing topics like Employee Motivation and Process Improvements.
5. Update the map continually by changing the "FALSE" fields to a tick mark as each specific item (e.g., Develop KPI's, Leadership 1) is explored and completed.

Common Q&A

1. **Q:** What are the three primary headers on the 1 Page Map? **A:** Get Organised, Get the Job, and Do the Job.
2. **Q:** What two categories fall under "Do the Job"? **A:** People (Getting the Most Out of the People You've Got) and Process (Making Improvements Step by Step).
3. **Q:** What specific items are tracked under the "Marketing" section? **A:** Marketing Answers, Curve & Cycle, 6 Marketing Statements, and 1 Page Marketing Plan.
4. **Q:** What specific items are tracked under the "Sales" section? **A:** Sales Design, Sales (Process) Flowchart, and Tension Point Scripts.
5. **Q:** How does the template track completion? **A:** It uses checkboxes marked "FALSE" that are intended to be ticked when the items to explore are completed.

Lite Funda Call & Email

Benefits

- **How it helps the business owner:** Offers a highly accessible, low-risk way (a 3-minute quiz) to gain insights into the opportunities and threats facing their business.

- **How it helps the advisor:** Provides tested, conversational phone scripts to secure permission to send a qualifying quiz, acting as a lead-generation tool without being overly "salesy".
- **Who it may be suitable for:** Advisors executing outbound phone campaigns to engage existing clients or cold prospects to generate leads for growth advisory services.

How to use the material in practice

1. Choose the appropriate script for your target: an existing client, a cold prospect (Option 1), or a cold prospect with a strong online presence (Option 2).
2. Initiate the call, verify they are free to speak, and briefly state your intent to help owners deal with business opportunities or threats.
3. Ask for permission to send a text or email link to an online quiz that takes less than 5 minutes to complete on a smartphone.
4. Explain the low-pressure next steps: After the quiz, you will discuss the results by phone, and if it's not a fit, "everyone walks away - no harm no foul".
5. Send the provided follow-up email/text containing the quiz link, assuring the prospect that answers are strictly confidential.

Common Q&A

1. **Q:** What should the advisor do if the prospect is not free to speak? **A:** Ask "When is a good time to phone back?" and schedule a call.
2. **Q:** How does "Cold Prospect - Option 2" differ from Option 1? **A:** Option 2 involves complimenting the prospect on the professional presentation of their website and social media before pitching the quiz.
3. **Q:** How long does the advisor say the quiz will take? **A:** Less than 5 minutes on the phone, and less than 3 minutes in the email.
4. **Q:** What is the advisor's stated intent when calling a cold prospect? **A:** To extend help to business owners who may not be getting the support they deserve in a difficult environment.
5. **Q:** What commitment is expected of the prospect after taking the quiz? **A:** A phone chat about the results, with no obligation to proceed further.

Lite Fundamentals Proposal

Benefits

- **How it helps the business owner:** Clearly breaks down the service offering into logical modules (Organised, Work, Profitable Work) and provides absolute certainty regarding fixed-price fees.

- **How it helps the advisor:** Standardizes the sales offering into a professional proposal, clearly defines the scope of work, and includes a legal mechanism to charge for out-of-scope variations.
- **Who it may be suitable for:** Prospects who have verbally agreed to the Lite Fundamentals program and require a formal, written agreement and fee structure before commencing.

How to use the material in practice

1. Present the proposal detailing the 3-part program: Getting More Organised, Getting More Work, and Doing More Profitable Work.
2. Walk the client through exactly "What we cover" and "Why we cover it" in each section, such as the 1 Page Marketing Plan or Process Improvement cycle.
3. Detail the exact financial investment required, outlining what is included and noting the proposal's validity period.
4. Explain the immediate next steps: loading auto-payments and organizing the 8 meeting dates.
5. Give the client preparation homework: thinking about personal income desires, exit plans, and ideal working hours.
6. If the client asks for extra work (e.g., bank finance proposals), complete the "Variation to Scope of Works" template with the issue, timeline, estimated hours, and fee increase, and have them sign it.

Common Q&A

1. **Q:** What topics are covered under "Doing More Profitable Work"? **A:** Employee Engagement (5 drivers of human output) and Process Improvement (Dave Nave systems comparison).
2. **Q:** Why does the proposal include Financial Accounting & Reporting? **A:** Because business is a constant process of testing, and accurate data/KPIs are critical to making better decisions.
3. **Q:** How many meetings will the advisor arrange once the 'go ahead' is given? **A:** 8 meetings.
4. **Q:** What specific questions should the business owner think about before the first meeting? **A:** Desired personal income, exit/succession plans, daily business tasks they wish to do more/less of, and desired working hours.
5. **Q:** How is out-of-scope work, such as assistance with a bank finance proposal, handled? **A:** Using the "Variation to Scope of Works" document to outline the project timeline, estimated hours, fee variations, and required signatures.

Lite Fundamentals Quiz Summary

Benefits

- **How it helps the business owner:** Gives them a rapid, low-risk introduction to the Growth Fundamentals Framework to help them understand what to focus on and what to ignore in their business.
- **How it helps the advisor:** Functions as a highly effective 'micro-step' to qualify prospects and 'prime them' for the main themes of the upcoming sales meeting.
- **Who it may be suitable for:** Existing clients and new prospects who are interacting with the advisor for the first time.

How to use the material in practice

1. Copy the provided Google Forms link (<https://forms.gle/wTQMa9BFbQ2PDUyY9>).
2. Send the link to the prospect to allow them to take the assessment.
3. Review the prospect's submitted answers to qualify their needs.
4. Use the results to guide and frame the 'early stages' of the sales script during your first formal meeting.

Common Q&A

1. **Q:** Who is the Growth Fundamentals Online Quiz intended for? **A:** Both existing clients and new prospects.
2. **Q:** Where is the quiz hosted? **A:** On Google Forms.
3. **Q:** What is the strategic purpose of this quiz in the sales cycle? **A:** It acts as a 'micro-step' between meeting for the first time and starting the Lite Fundamentals sales script.
4. **Q:** What does the quiz framework promise to help business owners do? **A:** Identify things they should focus on in their business, and things they should ignore for now.
5. **Q:** What should the advisor do with the quiz answers? **A:** Use them to qualify prospects and 'prime them' for the meeting's theme.

Lite Visuals

Benefits

- **How it helps the business owner:** Visually translates complex business theories—such as growth stages, legitimate constraints, and psychological biases—into easy-to-understand diagrams.
- **How it helps the advisor:** Provides a comprehensive visual aid deck to facilitate consulting sessions, making it easier to explain abstract concepts like interconnected business systems or "The Devil's Toilet".
- **Who it may be suitable for:** Visual learners and clients engaged in the Lite Fundamentals program who need graphical representations of their business challenges and KPIs.

How to use the material in practice

1. Present the "Growth Fundamentals Framework" slide to physically show the client the 9 stages of business growth.
2. Use the "What Got You Here / What Holds You Back" color-coded chart to help the client pinpoint their current growth stage.
3. Explain "The Devil's Toilet" analogy to warn clients transitioning from lifestyle to leverage about the dangers of complacency.
4. Discuss the "5 Layers of Complexity" and their associated "Psyche Errors" (like Optimism Bias or Over-Exposure) to address the mental blocks preventing growth.
5. Show the interconnected system flowcharts to demonstrate how Planning, Data, Marketing, Sales, People, and Process all feed into one another.

Common Q&A

1. **Q:** What is "The Devil's Toilet"? **A:** An analogy comparing a dangerous rapid on the Zambezi river to the treacherous business stage between 'lifestyle' and 'leverage' where high complacency exists.
2. **Q:** What are the three elements of Legitimate Constraints? **A:** Capacity (Transactional Volume), Capability (Skill sets & Resource), and Opportunity (Existing & Future Market Demand).
3. **Q:** What are the 5 Psyche Errors that owners try to avoid? **A:** Role-Identification, Over-Exposure, Optimism Bias, Complacency, and Confirmation Bias.
4. **Q:** How is 'Complacency' described in the visuals? **A:** As an inability to maintain attention on the external environment, often prevalent upon reaching a stage of perceived security.
5. **Q:** What types of visual charts are used to show KPI data? **A:** Cash Movement Summaries (bar charts), Debtor Days (dials), Gross Sales Margin (bar/line graphs), and Division Wages (pie charts).

Lite Fundamentals Session Content

1. PLANNING

Lite Planning Checklist

Benefits

- **How it helps the business owner:** It helps them map out their business expectations, current Growth Curve position, and profit potential using 'what if' capacity models.
- **How it helps the advisor:** It ensures all necessary documentation—from signed proposals to Advisor-e portal registration—is completed, and provides a clear agenda for the strategic planning session.
- **Who it may be suitable for:** New or existing clients establishing their baseline strategy, growth targets, and business performance ratios.

How to Use the Material in Practice (Step-by-Step)

1. Ensure the client completes the online quiz/sales process to rate business areas 1-5.
2. Have the client contribute thoughts on profit potential via a 'what if' capacity model.
3. Load the client's details into the Advisor-e portal and check their cell phone number for text action reminders.
4. Direct the client to watch the 'Pre-Planning' video and complete the 'Business Owners Expectations' tables.
5. Review the Owner Expectations tables before the session; postpone if they are not completed.
6. Enter the client's current and desired Growth Curve position and timeline into the Growth Fundamentals Framework tables.
7. Enter known data into the 'Planning Session' table and have performance ratios and Profit Potential models standing by.
8. Facilitate the Planning Session and log tasks into the Action Plan Reminder.

Common Q&A

- **Q:** What must be checked when registering the client in the Advisor-e portal? **A:** The client's cell phone number, to enable text action reminders.
- **Q:** What should the advisor do if the 'Owner Expectations' tables are incomplete? **A:** Remind the client and/or postpone the session if necessary.
- **Q:** What framework is used to map the client's current and desired business position? **A:** The Growth Fundamentals Framework.
- **Q:** What model should the advisor have 'standing by' for reference during the session? **A:** The Profit Potential model ('what if' models).
- **Q:** What document must a new client sign before proceeding? **A:** The Lite Fundamentals proposal and appropriate supplementary engagement terms.

Lite1.1 Support Planning

Benefits

- **How it helps the business owner:** It highlights mental blocks (like Confirmation Bias and Optimism Bias) that hinder planning, and explains how to build new habits to overcome them. It also breaks down the complexity of business growth stages.
- **How it helps the advisor:** It equips the advisor with models like De Bono's Collaborative Thinking and the '4-Box' Strategic Language to structure meeting facilitation and manage client behavior.
- **Who it may be suitable for:** Business teams entering strategic planning who need to establish a collaborative culture and a shared strategic language.

How to Use the Material in Practice (Step-by-Step)

1. Establish a Collaborative Framework (e.g., De-Bono's 6 Hats) and agree on Common Language to prevent cross-purposes.
2. Enforce a meeting culture of "Play the Ball; Not the Player" where individuals leave baggage outside.
3. Identify the Strategic Objective (a singular desired end result).
4. Formulate the Strategy (beliefs on how to achieve the objective) and Operational Objectives (measurable steps bound by a timeframe).
5. Determine Tactical Execution (the actual on-the-ground methods).
6. Address the "5 Steps to Building New Habits" (Reason, Trigger, Micro Habit, Effective Practice, Plan) to ensure the client can execute behavioral changes.
7. Map the business on the Growth Fundamentals Framework (Design, Launch, Break-even, Lifestyle, Leverage, Reach, Leapfrog, Maturity, Exit).

Common Q&A

- **Q:** What is Argumentative Theory in planning? **A:** It is the concept that our internalized thought processes are designed to serve our own needs, as proven by confirmation bias.
- **Q:** What behaviors are not allowed in a strategic planning session? **A:** Aggressive confrontation or passive-aggressive behavior such as sulking or cynical snipes.
- **Q:** What is the definition of an Operational Objective? **A:** It must be observable/measurable in its definitive assessment, bound by a timeframe, in support of the strategic objective, and consistent with the chosen strategy.
- **Q:** What is the "Devil's Toilet"? **A:** It is a dangerous rapid/phase between the 'lifestyle' and 'leverage' business stages, characterized by complacency and fatigue, where owners must 'bank profits' before moving forward.
- **Q:** What are the 5 Steps to Building New Habits? **A:** Reason, Trigger, Micro Habit, Effective Practice, and Plan.

Lite1.Planning

Benefits

- **How it helps the business owner:** It provides a clear agenda to articulate their personal income/lifestyle goals and aligns those expectations with actual operational objectives.
- **How it helps the advisor:** It offers a structured visual slide deck to guide the client from identifying what holds them back in their current growth stage to selecting specific profit levers.
- **Who it may be suitable for:** Clients needing to formalize a definitive action plan to scale their business from its current stage.

How to Use the Material in Practice (Step-by-Step)

1. Identify the client's Current Growth Stage Position on the Growth Fundamentals table.
2. Have the client complete the Business Owner Expectations table to record income, leisure time goals, and work effectiveness.
3. Complete the Business Development Stages table to record the 'scale dynamics' required to achieve those lifestyle goals.
4. Identify the Future (Desired) Growth Stage and Timeline.
5. Draft clear Operational Objectives (e.g., "Achieve \$150,000 per month in ongoing regular sales by end of Sept 2016").
6. Review the 8 Profit Levers (e.g., Number of Foot-traffic, Average Customer Spend, Fixed Costs).
7. Complete the Profit Lever table to select 'quick win' actions and record them in the Action Plan Reminder.

Common Q&A

- **Q:** What defines the "Lifestyle" growth stage? **A:** The business makes enough profit to allow the owner to draw sufficient funds to meet their lifestyle and save money each month.
 - **Q:** What holds a business back in the "Leverage" stage? **A:** Lack of faith in Key Staff, poor delegation, or a reluctance to 'let go'.
 - **Q:** What is a poor example of an operational objective? **A:** "Increase Sales".
 - **Q:** How do you calculate Total Revenue using the Profit Levers? **A:** Number of Foot-traffic x Prospects x Customers x Average Customer Spend x Average Customer Frequency.
 - **Q:** What profit lever aligns with the aim to "Keep them WANTING MORE"? **A:** Average Customer Spend and Average Customer Frequency.
-

2. DATA

Lite Data Checklist

Benefits

- **How it helps the business owner:** It ensures the owner is properly prepared for the data session by prompting them to watch pre-session videos, read 'Learn the Lingo' notes, and complete relevant tasks beforehand. It also helps them learn the difference between correlation, coincidence, and causation in business data.
- **How it helps the advisor:** It provides a structured, step-by-step checklist to track meeting preparation, ensuring pre-meeting pages are unlocked, explanatory emails are sent, and the physical room and refreshments are ready.
- **Who it may be suitable for:** Advisors and clients actively engaging in the "Lite Fundamentals Data Session".

How to Use the Material in Practice (Step-by-Step)

1. Verify the client has revisited the previous session's action tables and completed relevant tasks.
2. Unlock the Lite Data 'Client Pre Meeting' page in the system.
3. Send the client an explanatory email directing them to the 'Pre-Data' video and 'Learn the Lingo' notes.
4. Confirm the client has completed the required pre-meeting tasks.
5. Prepare the physical meeting room and arrange appropriate refreshments prior to the client's arrival.
6. Facilitate the Data Session using the appropriate story order (e.g., examining gross sales margins vs. system enquiries).
7. Send a follow-up email confirming the date and topic for the next session, and ensure all new 'tasks to do' are recorded in the Action Plan Reminder feature.

Common Q&A

- **Q:** What must the client review before the Data Session? **A:** The client must watch the 'Pre-Data' session video and review the 'Learn the Lingo' notes.
- **Q:** How do you track the tasks generated during the session? **A:** They should be recorded in the Action Plan Reminder feature so the client can tick them off upon completion.
- **Q:** What is an example of a "System Enquiry" regarding data? **A:** Discovering that salespeople are paid commission based on units sold rather than the margin achieved, which explains why stock purchase costs appear too high relative to margins.
- **Q:** How can data be misinterpreted? **A:** If gross sales margins increase without a change in business systems, one might wrongly assume salespeople changed their habits, when the actual driver was a temporary international currency movement.
- **Q:** Why is relying on temporary cost improvements dangerous? **A:** Because no actual business system improvement has occurred, leaving the business vulnerable in the future.

Lite2. Data

Benefits

- **How it helps the business owner:** It demystifies financial lingo (like Assets vs Liabilities) and teaches them how to calculate and manage their Working Capital Cycle.
- **How it helps the advisor:** It provides clear visual scenarios (e.g., 30 vs 60 day cycles) to help the advisor illustrate the difference between cash flow problems and profitability problems.
- **Who it may be suitable for:** Owners who are overtrading, experiencing cash shortages, or lacking financial management literacy.

How to Use the Material in Practice (Step-by-Step)

1. Teach the client to distinguish between Causation (direct influence), Correlation (observable but not causal), and Coincidence.
2. Map out the business's Working Capital Cycle (Cash -> Stock -> Sale -> Debtors -> Cash).
3. Compare current cycle speeds (e.g., 30 Day vs 60 Day cycles) to show how delayed debtor payments impact stock turn and cash flow.
4. Use provided scenarios to test if the client has a profitability problem, a lack of working capital, or a cash flow cycle problem.
5. Review the Balance Sheet (Assets = Liabilities + Owners Equity) alongside the Profit & Loss statement.
6. Select KPIs by asking, "If we knew the answer to X, how would that help us in our future decision making?" ensuring you measure things you can adjust.
7. Log financial measures in the KPI table.

Common Q&A

- **Q:** What is Over-Trading? **A:** The business growing faster than its internal ability to fund it via accumulated profits, often leading to debt/equity imbalance.
 - **Q:** What is W. Edward Deming's Theory of Volatility regarding a "Special Cause"? **A:** A Special Cause has Low Frequency but High Impact.
 - **Q:** If a business fails to complete a trading cycle in the same period because payment is delayed a month, do they have a cash flow problem? **A:** Yes, the same cash will arrive eventually, but if it happens regularly it reduces total annual sales/stock turn.
 - **Q:** What are the three uses of profits? **A:** To purchase new assets for growth, to repay debt, and to distribute to business owners.
 - **Q:** How do you calculate the Quick (working capital) Position ratio? **A:** $\text{Cash} + \text{Debtors} \div \text{Current Liabilities}$.
-

3. MARKETING

Lite Marketing Checklist

Benefits

- **How it helps the business owner:** It prompts the owner to clarify their product's market position by answering '6 Marketing Questions' and 'Our Product Fit' questions prior to meeting.
- **How it helps the advisor:** It allows the advisor to review the client's input notes in advance to gauge their current understanding and comfort level with marketing terminology.
- **Who it may be suitable for:** Clients and advisors preparing to structure the business's marketing fundamentals and messaging.

How to Use the Material in Practice (Step-by-Step)

1. Ensure the client has completed tasks from the previous session's action tables.
2. Unlock the Lite Marketing 'Client Pre Meeting' page.
3. Send an email directing the client to watch the 'Pre-Marketing' session video and fill out the '6 Marketing Questions' and 'Our Product Fit' tables.
4. Review the client's submitted notes in the Marketing input tables prior to the session to determine their comfort with the terminology.
5. Prepare the meeting room and arrange refreshments.
6. Facilitate the Marketing Session.
7. Send a follow-up email with the next session date, and load tasks into the Action Plan Reminder feature.

Common Q&A

- **Q:** What specific tables must the client complete before the marketing session? **A:** The '6 Marketing Questions' and the 'Our Product Fit' tables.
 - **Q:** Why should the advisor review the client's notes before the session? **A:** To determine the client's current understanding and comfort with marketing terminology.
 - **Q:** What must be unlocked for the client to begin? **A:** The Lite Marketing 'Client Pre Meeting' page.
 - **Q:** How does the advisor ensure the client completes their post-session work? **A:** By ensuring tasks are recorded in the Action Plan Reminder feature and that the client knows to tick them off.
 - **Q:** What is the very first step on the checklist? **A:** Checking if the client has revisited previous session action tables and shown signs of task completion.
-

Lite3. Marketing

Benefits

- **How it helps the business owner:** It helps them identify exactly what stage of awareness their prospects are in and build a structured "digital funnel" to capture and retain them.
- **How it helps the advisor:** It provides a comprehensive 1-Page Marketing Plan framework to help the client organize their target market, messaging, mediums, and budget.
- **Who it may be suitable for:** Businesses launching new products, entering new markets, or struggling to convert prospects into customers.

How to Use the Material in Practice (Step-by-Step)

1. Review the 6 Marketing Answers table to gain contextual understanding of the client's value proposition.

2. Plot the client's product on the Market Diffusion curve (Innovators, Early Adopters, Early/Late Majority, Laggards) and Product Life Cycle curve (Introduction, Growth, Maturity, Saturation, Decline).
3. Identify the target audience's Level of Consumer Awareness (No Idea, Vaguely Aware, Generally Aware, Motivated Awareness) to tailor the message.
4. Build the Digital Client On-Boarding Funnel by defining what is given away for free (to capture info), at low cost, mid-tier, and premium levels.
5. Complete the 6 Marketing Statements table (Who I Work With, My One Big Promise, What They Enjoy As A Result, What Makes me Unique, How I Work, The Magic Happens When...).
6. Finalize the strategy by completing the 1 Page Marketing Plan table (Target Market x Message x Mediums x Frequency/Budget).

Common Q&A

- **Q:** What is the difference between Market Diffusion Theory and Product Life Cycle? **A:** With diffusion theory, a market may reach saturation while the product still fulfills a need; with product life cycle, the product itself becomes obsolete.
- **Q:** What defines "Motivated Awareness"? **A:** The consumer recognizes the need/want, has motivation to act, but lacks problem detail so they look for guidance from an 'Industry Authority'.
- **Q:** What is the primary goal of the "Free Engagement (Trial) LEVEL" of the funnel? **A:** To respond to the level of engagement by providing relevance (e.g., e-book, video) in exchange for a name, email, or phone number.
- **Q:** What should occur once you have secured the customer at the bottom of the funnel? **A:** Focus on Retention and Expansion (Upsell) with the goal of creating Advocates.
- **Q:** What are the components of the 1 Page Marketing Plan? **A:** Target Market, Message, Mediums, and Frequency/Budget/Time.

4. SALES

Lite Sales Checklist

Benefits

- **How it helps the business owner:** It helps them evaluate how their sales process is currently structured by completing 'The Design of Our Sales Process' questions.
- **How it helps the advisor:** It provides a consistent administrative framework to verify the client has completed pre-work and allows the advisor to review the client's sales terminology comprehension.
- **Who it may be suitable for:** Clients needing to refine their sales tactics, conversion rates, and sales process architecture.

How to Use the Material in Practice (Step-by-Step)

1. Verify previous action items are showing signs of completion.
2. Unlock the Lite Sales 'Client Pre Meeting' page.
3. Direct the client via email to watch the 'Pre-Sales' video.
4. Instruct the client to complete 'The Design of Our Sales Process' table.
5. Review the 'Sales' input table prior to the meeting to gauge terminology comfort.
6. Set up the room, facilitate the session, and send the follow-up email.
7. Log all next steps in the Action Plan Reminder feature.

Common Q&A

- **Q:** What must the client complete to map out their sales approach beforehand? **A:** 'The Design of Our Sales Process' questions.
 - **Q:** What page needs to be unlocked by the advisor? **A:** The Lite Sales 'Client Pre Meeting' page.
 - **Q:** What video is assigned for this module? **A:** The 'Pre-Sales' session video.
 - **Q:** Where are post-session tasks logged? **A:** In the Action Plan Reminder feature.
 - **Q:** Why does the advisor review the input table early? **A:** To determine the client's current understanding and comfort with sales terminology.
-

Lite4. Sales

Benefits

- **How it helps the business owner:** It helps them map out the exact sequence of their customer interactions and script answers for predictable "tension points" or objections.
- **How it helps the advisor:** It allows the advisor to teach psychological processing styles (Honey & Mumford) and the concept of "congruence," ensuring the client builds a sales approach matching their industry.
- **Who it may be suitable for:** Sales teams or owners doing B2B/B2C selling, tender drafting, or those facing high objection rates.

How to Use the Material in Practice (Step-by-Step)

1. Identify the correct Sales Arena: Point of Sale, Consultancy, or Territory Management.
2. Establish Congruence (Physiology/Pace, Intent, Frameworks, Tonality) to build trust.
3. Design the process around the 4 Steps in the Psychology of the Sale: Identify Need/Want, Create Desire, Provide Solution, Help to Buy.
4. Adjust tactics to cater to the 4 Processing Styles: Activist, Pragmatist, Reflector, Theorist.
5. Complete the Sales Flowchart table to record every step of the 'customer experience' (asking "what happens next?").

6. Identify predictable objections and complete the Tension Point Scripts table.
7. Use the "Holes Not Drill Bits" concept to focus scripts on benefits (WHAT the feature does FOR the customer) rather than just features.

Common Q&A

- **Q:** What is the difference between Point of Sale and Consultancy selling? **A:** Point of sale is product/features oriented with emphasis on the close, while Consultancy occurs over a greater length of time with emphasis on investigative aspects.
 - **Q:** What happens if a salesperson lacks congruence? **A:** The customer notices a "poor vibe," goes into a higher state of alert, and looks for actions or words associated with danger.
 - **Q:** How does a "Pragmatist" process information? **A:** They are emotive but want reassurance; they seek PROOF via data, testimonials, statistics, and case studies.
 - **Q:** What is the "Holes Not Drill Bits" philosophy? **A:** Selling the benefit (clean holes exactly where you want them) rather than the feature (tungsten tipped material).
 - **Q:** When drafting a tender, why should you use separator cards? **A:** Because points will inevitably be re-visited, so you must make it easy for those involved to quickly find information.
-

5. PEOPLE

Lite People Checklist

Benefits

- **How it helps the business owner:** It forces the owner to reflect on staff engagement and performance by completing the 'Where Observation & Feedback is Critical' questions.
- **How it helps the advisor:** It provides an administrative framework to ensure all preparatory steps, from unlocking content to reviewing client inputs on terminology, are completed before the People Session begins.
- **Who it may be suitable for:** Businesses struggling with or looking to optimize team performance, leadership, and human resources.

How to Use the Material in Practice (Step-by-Step)

1. Check that the client has completed tasks from the prior session.
2. Unlock the 'Client Pre Meeting' page (Note: The document states unlocking the 'Lite Sales' page, which appears to be a typographical carryover in the source, but it applies to the People session).
3. Email the client instructions to watch the 'Pre-People' session video.
4. Instruct the client to complete the 'Where Observation & Feedback is Critical' table.

5. Review the client's completed 'People' input table to assess their terminology comprehension.
6. Facilitate the session, follow up via email, and log actions in the Action Plan Reminder.

Common Q&A

- **Q:** What video is the client directed to watch for this module? **A:** The 'Pre-People' session video.
 - **Q:** What specific table must the client fill out during their pre-work? **A:** The 'Where Observation & Feedback is Critical' questions table.
 - **Q:** Why does the advisor review the 'People' input table before the meeting? **A:** To determine the client's current understanding and comfort with the terminology.
 - **Q:** What is included in the follow-up email? **A:** The date and confirmed topic for the next session.
 - **Q:** How does the client track their post-session homework? **A:** Through the Action Plan Reminder feature.
-

Lite5. People

Benefits

- **How it helps the business owner:** It teaches them how to observe employee performance objectively, delegate effectively, and deliver feedback that actually improves behavior.
- **How it helps the advisor:** It gives the advisor frameworks (like the 5 Drivers of Human Output and the Progressive Learning Path) to coach clients on leadership and team structures.
- **Who it may be suitable for:** Business owners transitioning from "doers" to "managers," or organizations experiencing poor staff motivation.

How to Use the Material in Practice (Step-by-Step)

1. Diagnose staff performance issues using the 5 Drivers of Human Output: Knowledge, Skill, Resource, Environment, Mindset.
2. Recognize the Emotional Reaction Towards Learning Curve (Shock, Avoidance, Testing, Acceptance) so owners don't expect linear learning.
3. Delegate tasks using the 4-step model: Clarify (who owns the problem), Agree (Task, Whom, When), Direct (freedom level), Review (follow up).
4. Provide feedback using the IPP model (Improvement, Praise, Praise) rather than PIP, ensuring you deal in observed behavior.
5. Address the 80/20 of Employee Motivation by ensuring Security, Autonomy/Contribution, and Fair Rewards are met.

6. Complete the Leadership tables to identify areas for leadership improvement (e.g., evaluating Creative Abrasion, Agility, Resolution).
7. Copy and paste the Organizational Chart to clarify reporting lines.

Common Q&A

- **Q:** What are the 5 Drivers of Human Output? **A:** Knowledge, Skill, Resource, Environment, and Mindset.
 - **Q:** Why is the standard PIP (Praise, Improvement, Praise) feedback model flawed? **A:** People wait for the "but," become defensive, and miss or diminish the power of the first praise.
 - **Q:** How do you execute the IPP feedback model? **A:** Hit them with 1 key Improvement needed (be specific on behavior), get the words from their mouths on how to improve, and then support with 2 specific Positives.
 - **Q:** What is "Creative Abrasion" in team leadership? **A:** Encouraging healthy debate and contribution where teams 'play the ball and not the player' to amplify diversification of ideas.
 - **Q:** What are the three main drivers of employee motivation? **A:** Security, Autonomy/Contribution, and Fair Rewards.
-

6. PROCESS

Lite Process Checklist

Benefits

- **How it helps the business owner:** It requires the owner to analyze their current operational workflows by completing the 'Current Process In Review' questions.
- **How it helps the advisor:** It streamlines meeting preparation and provides early insight into the client's operational bottlenecks and terminology understanding.
- **Who it may be suitable for:** Clients focusing on identifying and improving business processes and systems.

How to Use the Material in Practice (Step-by-Step)

1. Check the client's progress on previous action tables.
2. Unlock the Lite Process 'Client Pre Meeting' page.
3. Send an email directing the client to the 'Pre-Process' video and the 'Current Process In Review' table.
4. Wait for the client to complete the pre-meeting tasks.
5. Review the client's notes in the 'Process' input table.
6. Prepare the meeting environment, facilitate the session, and send the follow-up email.
7. Record required actions in the Action Plan Reminder feature.

Common Q&A

- Q: What video corresponds to this specific checklist? A: The 'Pre-Process' session video.
 - Q: What specific questions must the client complete in the pre-meeting phase? A: The 'Current Process In Review' questions.
 - Q: What is the purpose of reviewing the Process input table? A: To determine the client's current understanding or comfort with terminology.
 - Q: How does the client know what tasks to complete after the session? A: They are recorded in the Action Plan Reminder feature.
 - Q: When is the topic for the subsequent session confirmed? A: It is confirmed at the Process Session and included in the follow-up email.
-

Lite6. Process

Benefits

- **How it helps the business owner:** It helps them identify bottlenecks, standardize operations, and choose the correct systems philosophy (Six Sigma, Lean, or Theory of Constraints) to reduce waste and variation.
- **How it helps the advisor:** It outlines a clear Process Improvement Cycle and logical flowcharting rules to guide the client in redesigning their business operations.
- **Who it may be suitable for:** Businesses requiring strict adherence to compliance, facing high health and safety concerns, or looking to franchise/scale heavily.

How to Use the Material in Practice (Step-by-Step)

1. Define the difference between a Process (sequence of actions to produce a component) and a System (interdependent processes acting as a whole).
2. Execute the Process Improvement Cycle: Identify, Design, Test, Implement, Review.
3. Choose an overarching systems philosophy (e.g., Six Sigma to reduce variation, Lean to remove waste, Theory of Constraints to manage bottlenecks).
4. Design the system by defining Inputs, System Function, and Outputs.
5. Create visual flowcharts using Nodes (action steps) and Links (sequence), keeping illustrations between 5 to 13 Nodes to prevent information overload.
6. Write Nodes on 'sticky notes' to test and shift the logical order creatively.
7. Complete the Systems Improve tables to record the specific systems to focus on and tasks to undertake, then load them into the action plan reminder.

Common Q&A

- Q: What is the difference between a process and a system? A: A process is a sequence of actions to produce a component (e.g., building an engine), while a system is a collection of interdependent processes acting as a whole (e.g., assembling the car).
- Q: What is the primary focus of "Lean thinking"? A: Flow focused, aiming to remove waste.
- Q: What are the two most important aspects of any SYSTEM? A: DESIGN (Architecture) and FEEDBACK LOOP.
- Q: How many Nodes should generally be in a flowchart illustration? A: Between 5 to 13 Nodes.
- Q: What is a Redundant System? A: A system where whole sections can shut down or be replaced by another system in the event of major system error.

Strategic Tools

The following summary relates to content stored in the Strategic Tools section of Advisor-e. This content is designed to help advisors secure advisory engagements with new and existing clients. The content is focused on FACILITATION and therefore, is better suited to advisors who have previous experience in running client meetings without supervision and are confident to deliver complex business concepts.

This presentation outlines a structured framework for conducting strategic business planning sessions aimed at uncovering hidden opportunities and creating actionable growth plans. The process is divided into four core planning domains: establishing financial and personal business targets, evaluating strategic orientation, improving organisational efficiency, and refining sales and marketing strategies. To facilitate deep analysis, the sources provide various theoretical frameworks—such as Porter's Five Forces and the Blue Ocean Strategy—to challenge existing beliefs and explore new market possibilities. Participants are encouraged to engage in collaborative thinking and use contrast modeling to bridge the gap between their current operations and future goals. Ultimately, these slides serve as a comprehensive guide for facilitators and business owners to prepare for, execute, and document a rigorous review of their company's health and trajectory.

1. 80/20 Farm Plan

- Purpose: Applies the Pareto Principle (80% of results come from 20% of activities) specifically to agricultural businesses. It breaks the farm down into four focus areas: Financial, Herd, People, and Land Management.
- Helps the Business Owner: Allows the farmer to choose specific focus periods (30, 60, 90 days), set realistic tasks, and map specific daily practices (e.g., herd hydration, pasture management, machinery maintenance) directly to financial consequences and key points of measurement.
- Helps the Advisor: Provides a structured, industry-specific framework to consult on farm metrics and translate physical farming activities into financial discussions.
- Indicators for Use: The client operates an agricultural or farming business and needs help prioritizing daily operations to improve financial yield.

2. 9 Growth Aspect Questions & Graphic

- Purpose: A diagnostic tool that divides a business into nine holistic aspects: Process Improvement, Customer Focus, Sales, Authenticity, Inventory & Equipment, Team Focus, Innovation, Governance, and Harmony/Balance.
- Helps the Business Owner: Prompts deep reflection via specific questions on all facets of their business—from checking their ideal client profile to assessing their own physical fitness and work-life balance.
- Helps the Advisor: Acts as a comprehensive "health check" to uncover hidden bottlenecks, allowing the advisor to pinpoint exactly where the client needs the most strategic intervention.
- Indicators for Use: A new client onboarding process, or when an existing client feels "stuck" but cannot articulate exactly which part of the business is failing.

3. ADV.0. Planning Outcomes

- Purpose: Sets the agenda, collaborative rules, and scope for a strategic planning session across four domains: Business Targets, Strategic Orientation, Organisational Review, and Sales & Marketing.
- Helps the Business Owner: Prepares them mentally to explore issues with an "open heart and an open mind," clarifying exactly what deliverables they will walk away with.
- Helps the Advisor: Defines the advisor's role clearly (to "Challenge What You Believe To Be True!") and provides a roadmap to structure the planning session without getting derailed.
- Indicators for Use: The beginning of any major strategic planning cycle or workshop.

4. Advance.1. Bizz Targets & BO Expectations

- Purpose: Helps define and map out tangible business targets (revenue, profit, debt) and aligns them with Business Owner (BO) lifestyle expectations (income, weekly hours, annual leave) across current and future stages. It also explores the 8 Profit Levers to tacticalize growth.
- Helps the Business Owner: Forces owners to quantify their end-game and lifestyle goals, map their current business development stage (from Design to Maturity/Exit), and clearly see how their personal time must shift from technician duties to strategic duties.
- Helps the Advisor: Translates a client's abstract desires into a numerical roadmap, providing a clear mathematical and tactical gap analysis to consult against.
- Indicators for Use: Business owners who are burnt out, partners who have misaligned goals, or businesses needing to translate goals into mathematical targets.

5. Advance.2 & 2B. Strategic Orientation (Part 1 & 2)

- Purpose: Explores high-level strategic frameworks to review the business model. It utilizes tools like Porter's 5 Forces, Joseph Pine's Progression of Economic Value, the Sigmoid Curve, Blue Ocean Strategy, and Deming's Volatility Theory.
- Helps the Business Owner: Challenges market assumptions, helps anticipate competitor/supplier movements, identifies when a product might become obsolete, and helps shift offerings from commodities to premium experiences. It also helps owners recognize their own "Psyche Errors" like Optimism Bias or Complacency.
- Helps the Advisor: Elevates the conversation from operational tactics to high-level market strategy, providing robust frameworks to guide clients through complex market environments.
- Indicators for Use: Clients facing heavy competition, market disruption, stagnant product sales, or those needing to rethink their fundamental value proposition.

6. Advance.4. S.W.O.T PEST

- Purpose: A traditional internal/external analysis matrix (Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities, Threats) combined with P.E.S.T. (Political, Economic, Social, Technological) prompts.
- Helps the Business Owner: Provides a straightforward way to assess their current market position, internal resource gaps, and external regulatory or economic impacts.
- Helps the Advisor: Quickly captures a snapshot of the client's situational awareness and environmental risks.
- Indicators for Use: Clients needing a foundational baseline assessment before making a major strategic decision.

7. Advance.5. Sales & Marketing Review

- Purpose: Reviews the entire customer acquisition and retention journey using frameworks like the A.I.D.C.R.A model, 10 Critical Marketing Messages, Digital Funnel Storyboarding, and Packaging/Pricing options.
- Helps the Business Owner: Shifts their focus from loving their product to understanding customer friction. It helps build a structured digital funnel to onboard clients and create sticky, concise marketing messages.
- Helps the Advisor: Provides a step-by-step diagnostic tool to find "leaks" in the client's sales pipeline and build a cohesive, multi-channel marketing plan.
- Indicators for Use: Clients with great products but poor sales, high customer acquisition costs, or those transitioning to digital marketing.

8. Advance.6. Organisational Review & Org Chart

- Purpose: Focuses on internal efficiencies and team engagement by mapping communication channels, defining cultural core values, and building formal Organizational Charts with clear reporting lines and KPIs.
- Helps the Business Owner: Clarifies "who is responsible for what," helps define a safe social contract (culture) for the team, and establishes a military-style chain of command to ensure consistent actions under pressure.
- Helps the Advisor: Exposes structural bottlenecks, toxic cultural habits, or overlapping leadership roles that are hindering business execution.
- Indicators for Use: Companies experiencing rapid team growth, high staff turnover, operational chaos, or owners struggling to delegate.

9. Business Dating

- Purpose: Uses the metaphor of relationships (One Night Stand, Dating, Engaged, Married) to evaluate Alliance vs. Acquisition strategies based on the matrix of Attraction vs. Security/Commitment.
- Helps the Business Owner: Prevents owners from rushing into a "marriage" (acquisition/merger) without proper due diligence or alignment of cultures.
- Helps the Advisor: Provides a non-threatening, easily understood metaphor to facilitate complex conversations about the risks of M&A and joint ventures.
- Indicators for Use: Clients considering buying a competitor, merging, or forming a deep strategic partnership.

10. Force Field Analysis

- Purpose: A conflict resolution and brainstorming tool to identify the forces pushing a group toward a goal and the forces holding them back.

- Helps the Business Owner: Visually separates the people from the problem ("play the ball, not the player"), reducing guilt/shame while building urgency by defining the "Worst Case" scenario.
- Helps the Advisor: Acts as an excellent "bloodletting" exercise to manage a group with potential for conflict, enabling the advisor to unblock stalled planning.
- Indicators for Use: Teams facing internal resistance to change, conflict between directors, or a failure to execute past plans due to hidden fears.

11. Lite Strategy

- Purpose: A highly condensed, agile business plan encompassing the growth curve, target customer, ethos, profit levers, and a three-part market assumption test (Situation, Business Model, Acid Test).
- Helps the Business Owner: Gets the core business strategy down on paper quickly without being overwhelmed by excessive theoretical models.
- Helps the Advisor: Allows for rapid deployment of a strategic plan for clients who lack the time, budget, or complexity for a massive strategic overhaul.
- Indicators for Use: Startups, small businesses, or agile clients needing a fast strategic roadmap.

12. Pivot

- Purpose: A rapid framework (Identify Resistance -> Choose Fronts -> Rehearse Message -> Trial Prototype -> Review) designed for agile business owners to test new directions.
- Helps the Business Owner: Encourages testing ideas and messaging on a strict budget and timeline before committing massive capital to a full strategic shift.
- Helps the Advisor: Provides a structured way to guide an entrepreneurial client out of a crisis or into a new market iteratively.
- Indicators for Use: Clients facing a sudden market shock, an obsolete product line, or needing to quickly test a new idea.

13. Porter's & Pine

- Purpose: Fuses Michael Porter's 5 Competitive Forces with Joseph Pine's Progression of Economic Value (Extracting Commodities -> Making Goods -> Delivering Services -> Staging Experiences).
- Helps the Business Owner: Shows them how to escape price wars (commoditization) by elevating their product into a premium, authentic customer experience (like Starbucks did with coffee beans).
- Helps the Advisor: Provides a powerful visual narrative to convince clients that they must invest in customer connection and experience, rather than just lowering prices to fight competitors.

- Indicators for Use: Clients whose margins are being squeezed by competitors, or businesses struggling to differentiate their standard services.

Specialist Tools

The following summary relates to content stored in the Specialist Tools section of Advisor-e. This content is designed to help advisors secure advisory engagements with new and existing clients. The content is focused on ADVICE and therefore, is better suited to advisors who have previous experience in running client meetings without supervision and are confident to deliver complex business concepts.

Due Diligence

Part 1: Template Benefits and Applications

1. Asset Review 1

- **Benefits:** This template provides a granular financial and operational breakdown of a company's physical assets. It calculates the net value of items, categorizes them by operational necessity (Vital, Necessary, Useful), and determines the utilization hours required to service monthly payments.
- **How it helps the Business Owner:** It explicitly highlights "Capital Release Potential" by identifying underutilized assets that can be sold (Released) rather than kept (Held).
- **How it helps the Advisor:** Advisors can use this to quickly spot bloated balance sheets and advise on immediate cash-generation strategies prior to or post-acquisition.
- **Suitable for:** Asset-heavy businesses such as logistics, manufacturing, and construction companies.

2. DD Advisor Material

- **Benefits:** Acts as the strategic roadmap for the entire M&A process. It breaks due diligence into 5 clear phases: Strategic Alignment, Information Gathering, The "Three Pillars" (Financial, Legal, Operational), Risk Assessment, and Integration Planning.

- **How it helps the Business Owner:** Educates the buyer on exactly what to look for, such as "Change of Control" clauses or "add-backs" to EBITDA, preventing costly deal mistakes.
- **How it helps the Advisor:** Provides a structured, phased checklist to keep the deal team aligned, ensuring legal, financial, and cultural elements are reviewed systematically.
- **Suitable for:** Private equity firms, search funds, or any business owner looking to merge with or acquire another entity.

3. DD Customer Review

- **Benefits:** Offers a mathematical breakdown of revenue concentration. It ranks clients by fee range, calculates the percentage of engaged clients, and tracks the sales performance of individual staff members.
- **How it helps the Business Owner:** Visually maps out exactly where the money comes from, highlighting dangerous revenue dependencies (e.g., if a few clients make up a massive percentage of the rolling fee base).
- **How it helps the Advisor:** Allows the advisor to quantify the stability of the target's cash flow and evaluate the efficiency of the sales team.
- **Suitable for:** B2B companies, professional service firms, and agencies with defined client rosters.

4. DD Key Interviews

- **Benefits:** Shifts the focus from quantitative data to qualitative reality. It provides structured questionnaires tailored for Key Staff, the CFO, Key Suppliers, and Key Customers.
- **How it helps the Business Owner:** Uncovers hidden threats that don't appear on a balance sheet, such as toxic company culture, looming supplier disruptions, or customer dissatisfaction.
- **How it helps the Advisor:** Provides standard, probing questions (e.g., asking the CFO about KPI trends or asking customers what the business could do better) to test the validity of the seller's claims.
- **Suitable for:** Any target business with an active workforce, supply chain, and customer base.

5. GP: Opportunity Assessment

- **Benefits:** A comprehensive executive summary tool. It includes a Business Canvas (mapping threats and synergies), Quick Fire Financials (calculating EBITDA, OPEX ratios, and Payback Periods), an Org Chart, and a Weighted Scoring system.

- **How it helps the Business Owner:** Condenses massive amounts of due diligence data into an easy-to-read "Proceed" or "No Go" format based on an overall risk score.
- **How it helps the Advisor:** Standardizes the evaluation of multiple different targets by scoring them out of 5 across categories like "Historical Profits", "Entry Barrier", and "Goodwill Transferability".
- **Suitable for:** Investment boards, advisory committees, or buyers evaluating multiple acquisition targets simultaneously.

6. Location Review

- **Benefits:** A demographic and geographic scoring matrix that evaluates locations based on Population Base, Customer Potential, Market Share, Residential Desirability, and Supply Logistics.
- **How it helps the Business Owner:** Prevents poor real estate investments by forcing an objective look at foot traffic, workforce availability, and logistical complexity.
- **How it helps the Advisor:** Provides a data-driven justification for advising a client to enter or avoid a specific physical market.
- **Suitable for:** Retail franchises, hospitality venues, and distribution centers.

7. Revenue Porter's - Sheet1

- **Benefits:** Adapts Porter's Five Forces into a product-by-product revenue analysis, assessing customer demand, supplier options, and barriers to entry.
- **How it helps the Business Owner:** Identifies which products have true pricing power (e.g., customers are likely to pay a premium) versus products at risk from substitutes.
- **How it helps the Advisor:** Helps in restructuring a target company's offerings post-acquisition by trimming weak product lines and doubling down on strong ones.
- **Suitable for:** Wholesale, retail, and manufacturing businesses with diverse product catalogs.

Part 2: Putting the Framework into Practice (Step-by-Step Method)

Executing a proper due diligence framework requires a phased, sequential approach to prevent critical details from slipping through the cracks.

Step 1: The Initial Filter (Macro Assessment) Begin with the GP: Opportunity Assessment and the Location Review. Populate the Quick Fire Financials template to ensure the target meets your required Return on Assets (ROA) and Payback Period criteria. Use the Location matrix to

confirm the geographic fundamentals are sound. If the target scores poorly in this macro screening, walk away before investing money into a deep diligence process.

Step 2: Strategic Planning & Alignment If the target passes the initial filter, open the DD Advisor Material. Define your "Why" or investment thesis (e.g., geographic expansion, talent acqui-hire, or technology acquisition) to guide your deal team. Assemble this deal team by bringing together internal leaders (CEO, HR, Operations) and external experts (M&A Accountant, Commercial Lawyer, IT Consultant). Lock in your framework by executing a Non-Disclosure Agreement (NDA) and a Letter of Intent (LOI) to establish timelines (typically 30-90 days) and an exclusivity period. Finally, have the seller populate a Virtual Data Room (VDR) and organize the data streams comprehensively (Legal, Financials, HR, Operations) so specialists can work in parallel.

Step 3: The Financial, Legal, and Asset Deep Dive With the VDR open, execute the structural deep dives:

- **Asset & Financial Review:** Utilize Asset Review 1 to cross-reference equipment lists against debt to determine what is vital and what should be liquidated. Conduct a Quality of Earnings (QoE) review to check EBITDA for artificial inflations, analyze working capital, and review 3-5 years of tax filings.
- **Legal Review:** Check material contracts for "Change of Control" clauses that might terminate agreements post-sale, verify Intellectual Property (IP) ownership, and investigate pending litigation.
- **Customer & Operational Assessment:** Run the DD Customer Review to ensure revenue isn't concentrated in the hands of a few clients (e.g., one client making up >20% of revenue). Evaluate the underlying tech stack to identify hidden integration costs.

Step 4: The Qualitative Reality Check & Operational Fit Because financials only tell part of the story, deploy the DD Key Interviews. Send your deal team to speak with the CFO to test the numbers, and interview key suppliers and customers to gauge loyalty, hidden bottlenecks, impending market threats, and their willingness to accept a change in ownership. Additionally, use the FORD Model to assess staff relationships and ensure the business does not carry major risk by relying entirely on a single key person.

Step 5: Product & Market Moat Assessment Run the target's core products or services through the Revenue Porter's matrix. This template will help you determine if the business possesses actual pricing power or if it is highly vulnerable to new market entrants and substitute products.

Step 6: Risk Assessment, Final Scoring & Negotiation Compile all of the deal team's findings into a comprehensive Due Diligence Report. Return to the GP: Opportunity Assessment and fill out the "Weighted Scores" tab based on everything uncovered in Steps 3 through 5. Leverage these findings and the final score to identify deal-breakers, validate your offering price, or renegotiate the purchase price and structure (such as instituting an Earn-out to retain key staff). Ensure all renegotiated terms, warranties, and indemnities are legally bound in the final Sales & Purchase Agreement (SPA).

Step 7: Integration Planning Start planning for "Day 1" during the diligence phase, not after the deal closes. Map out a communication plan for both customers and staff, and decide early on which software and CRM platforms will survive the merger.

Would you like me to elaborate on the specific checks within the legal and financial deep dives, or perhaps create an artifact like a checklist report for you based on this process?-----

Part 3: Common Q&A

Q1: Why shouldn't we just trust the provided Profit & Loss (P&L) statement?

A: The P&L alone doesn't show the full financial truth. You must conduct a Quality of Earnings (QoE) analysis to identify "add-backs" (owner perks or one-time expenses) that might be artificially inflating the target company's EBITDA.

Q2: What is the biggest hidden risk in client bases?

A: Customer concentration. If a single client accounts for more than 20% of the company's revenue, the risk to the buyer is exceptionally high if that client decides to leave post-acquisition.

Q3: How do material contracts legally threaten an acquisition?

A: Many material contracts contain "Change of Control" clauses. This means agreements with vital suppliers or key customers may automatically terminate the moment the business changes hands, immediately devaluing the company.

Q4: How does technology compatibility impact the deal?

A: Merging a company that uses modern, cloud-based infrastructure with one relying on legacy, paper-based systems can result in massive, hidden integration costs. An IT audit is essential to uncover these "tech debts".

Q5: When is the right time to start planning the post-merger integration?

A: Best practice dictates that you start planning the "Day 1" integration (such as communication plans and system process mapping) *during* the due diligence phase, not after the deal closes.

Q6: What happens if a company relies heavily on one key employee?

A: If a business relies entirely on one "key person" to function or maintain client relationships, the core value of the business drops significantly due to the flight risk. This often requires renegotiating terms, like adding an Earn-out to ensure they stay.

Part 4*: The FORD Model

*The FORD Model is a powerful communication and relationship-building framework traditionally used to build rapport. In the context of business advisory and leadership, it serves as a "soft" due diligence tool to assess staff morale, engagement, and alignment during transitions.

By focusing on [Family, Occupation, Recreation, and Dreams](#), you can move beyond transactional management and understand the human drivers behind a team.

The Four Pillars of the FORD Model

1. Family (and Background)

This isn't about prying into private lives, but understanding the context of a staff member's life.

- Assessment Goal: Identify stability and external pressures.
- Key Questions: Who are the key influencers in their life? Do they have caretaking responsibilities that affect their work-life balance?
- Leadership Insight: Understanding "Family" helps you tailor flexibility and support, which is often a higher motivator than a small salary bump.

2. Occupation

This focuses on their current role and their history within the organization.

- Assessment Goal: Gauge job satisfaction and technical confidence.
- Key Questions: What part of their daily workflow do they find most frustrating? What are they most proud of achieving in the last six months?

- Leadership Insight: This reveals "friction points" in your current processes (e.g., outdated software or communication bottlenecks).

3. Recreation

What does the person do to recharge?

- Assessment Goal: Understand personality, energy levels, and potential "burnout" risk.
- Key Questions: How do they spend their weekends? Are they involved in community or sports groups?
- Leadership Insight: A staff member with no "Recreation" may be at high risk for burnout. Conversely, their hobbies might reveal hidden skills (e.g., a junior accountant who coaches a team likely has untapped leadership potential).

4. Dreams (and Aspirations)

This is the most critical pillar for staff retention during a merger or growth phase.

- Assessment Goal: Align their personal trajectory with the company's roadmap.
- Key Questions: Where do they want to be in three years? If they could change one thing about their career path, what would it be?
- Leadership Insight: If a staff member's "Dream" is to specialize in AI-driven advisory, but the firm is sticking to traditional compliance, they are a high flight risk.

Why the FORD Model Matters in Business Advisory

When you are merging two firms or conducting due diligence, the FORD model allows you to perform a Cultural Audit:

- Identifying "Key Person" Risk: If the "Dreams" of the top three earners don't involve the new merged entity, your acquisition value is at risk.
- Building Rapid Rapport: In a "Team Disruption" or "Vibe Coding" session, using FORD helps lower defenses. People feel seen as individuals rather than "resources" or "FTEs" (Full-Time Equivalents).
- Mapping the Johari Window: You can use FORD to move information from the *Hidden Area* (what they know but you don't) to the *Open Area*, creating a more transparent and collaborative culture.

Business Valuations

1. Valuation Approach Letter ("Val approach ltr")

- Benefits: Acts as a non-threatening icebreaker to introduce the concept of business value to a client. It uses a relatable "car in reverse" analogy to explain how a business should pay its owner.
- How it helps the business owner: It shifts the owner's mindset toward treating the business as an investment that must be prepared and "dressed for sale," prompting them to think about long-term wealth extraction.
- How it helps the advisor: It serves as an effective lead-generation tool, opening the door for a consultative conversation without requiring the client to immediately commit to a massive project.
- Suitable for: Existing business clients who have not yet formalised a succession plan or are unaware of their business's current market value.

2. Value Scope Email

- Benefits: Clearly establishes the boundaries, legal limitations, and cost expectations of the engagement. It explicitly notes that the assessment is not a formal valuation and does not comply with Uniform Standard Professional Appraisal Practice standards.
- How it helps the business owner: It provides clarity on exactly what they are paying for (a fee range of \$1,500 to \$3,000), what the process entails, and what is excluded (e.g., formal negotiations or financing discussions).
- How it helps the advisor: Protects the advisor from legal liability associated with formal certified valuations. It acts as a clear agreement that prevents scope creep, explicitly defining tasks like negotiation as a separate "variation to scope".
- Suitable for: Any client who has verbally agreed to proceed with an indicative value assessment and needs formal terms before work begins.

3. Indicative Value Questions

- Benefits: A thorough discovery document that captures a 360-degree view of the business, covering competitors, threats, unrealised gains, asset conditions, and key dependencies.
- How it helps the business owner: Forces the owner to critically evaluate their operational vulnerabilities, such as dependency on key staff/customers, expiring stock, or whether current financials truly reflect the business's potential.
- How it helps the advisor: Standardises the data collection process, ensuring no critical variables (like required add-backs, lease terms, or asset depreciation) are missed before generating the final report.

- Suitable for: Both buyers looking to perform due diligence on a target company and sellers preparing their data for a realistic market assessment.

4. Business Assessment Report (Purchaser Focus)

- Benefits: Evaluates a target business using an Asset-Based method combined with "3-Point Sensitivities" (serviceability, goodwill payback, and performance variance).
- How it helps the business owner (Purchaser): Provides a clear "margin for error" calculation, highlighting how vulnerable the target business is to economic decline. It acts as a risk-assessment tool, preventing the purchaser from paying a "super profit" multiple without evidence.
- How it helps the advisor: Gives the advisor a highly professional, structured presentation format to walk the client through complex topics like Fair Market Value, EBPITDA versus EBITDA, and serviceability thresholds.
- Suitable for: Clients actively evaluating the purchase of an existing business.

5. Business Sale Assessment Report (Vendor Focus)

- Benefits: Mirrors the purchaser assessment but is strategically framed to place the seller in the "negotiation seat" of the purchaser.
- How it helps the business owner (Vendor): Empowers the seller to understand how a buyer will scrutinise their asking price, particularly regarding the "bankability" of the deal and the goodwill payback period. It helps them structure an offer that a buyer can confidently finance.
- How it helps the advisor: Allows the advisor to manage the vendor's price expectations realistically, ensuring the business goes to market at a defensible, structured price.
- Suitable for: Business owners actively preparing to list their business for sale.

6. Supplementary Assessment Reports (Purchaser & Vendor versions)

- Benefits: Introduces a "Notional Liquidation" approach to identify the absolute "worst case" or bottom-dollar recovery value of a business.
- How it helps the business owner: Clarifies the financial risk areas in advance, such as high debt-to-equity ratios or the devastating impact of forced asset disposal and taxation.
- How it helps the advisor: Provides a tool to stress-test financial management decisions or deliver a reality check to clients operating distressed businesses or experiencing severe shareholder disputes.
- Suitable for: Businesses in distress, highly risk-averse purchasers, or business planning sessions focusing on worst-case scenario stress-testing.

Step-by-Step Practice Methodology

- Step 1: Initiate Contact. Send the Val approach ltr to plant the seed about business value. Follow up with a brief introductory call or Zoom meeting.
- Step 2: Define the Engagement. Once the client shows interest, send the Value Scope email. Do not proceed until the client confirms acceptance of the \$1,500 - \$3,000 fee and acknowledges the indicative (non-formal) nature of the report.
- Step 3: Discovery Phase. Dispatch the Indicative Value Questions document. Conduct a guided session with the client to work through the document, uncovering hidden threats, unrealised gains, and asset specifics.
- Step 4: Develop the Primary Report. Based on whether the client is buying or selling, compile the Business Assessment Report or Business Sale Assessment Report. Apply the data from the discovery phase to calculate the 3-Point Sensitivities (Bankable Price, Goodwill Repayment Period, and Performance Variance).
- Step 5: Stress-Test (Optional/Situational). If the client is highly risk-averse, or if the target/current business is distressed, run the Supplementary Assessment Report to establish a baseline liquidation value.
- Step 6: Presentation and Review. Present the findings to the client, using the slide deck to visually guide them through the risk metrics, goodwill components, and final indicative value ranges.

Common Q&A

Q1: Is this assessment a certified, formal business valuation?

Answer: No. The scope explicitly states that it is an indicative assessment, not a formal valuation. It does not comply with Uniform Standard Professional Appraisal Practice standards, and assets/stock are not independently authenticated.

Q2: What core methodology is used to assess the business value?

Answer: The reports utilise an Asset-Based method inclusive of tangible and intangible assets, stress-tested by "3-Point Sensitivities." This ensures the value is grounded in reality, focusing on debt serviceability, goodwill payback from super profits, and defined performance variances.

Q3: Why do the reports calculate a "Margin for Error"?

Answer: The Margin for Error highlights the business's vulnerability to external economic decline or unexpected drops in sales. It is an assessment of personal financial risk for the buyer, rather than just an assessment of the business's theoretical value.

Q4: Will the advisor help negotiate the sale or secure financing based on this report?

Answer: Assisting with negotiations, financing, or resolving disputes falls outside the core scope of this 1,500–3,000 engagement. However, these services can be provided as a formally communicated "variation to scope".

Q5: What is the purpose of the Notional Liquidation value in the Supplementary Report?

Answer: It identifies the "bottom dollar" or worst-case recovery value after accounting for taxation, disposal costs, and liabilities. It's highly appropriate for businesses in distress or to highlight the downsides of previous management decisions.

Q6: Why does the seller report ask the owner to look from the purchaser's viewpoint? *Answer:*

To ensure the sale structure is realistic. By anticipating how a purchaser will assess the "bankability" of the deal and alternative investments, the seller can build a robust, evidence-backed case to support their asking price.

Source Summary Table

Template Name	Core Focus & Contents
Val approach ltr	An introductory outreach letter using a "car in reverse" analogy to prompt existing clients to think about extracting value from their business and trigger an assessment meeting.
Value Scope email	A formal engagement outline explicitly defining the assessment as non-formal (indicative), outlining fees (1,500–3,000), limiting liability, and establishing the next steps.

Indicative Questions	Value	A comprehensive discovery questionnaire gathering critical data on competitors, dependencies, unrealised gains, stock conditions, and tangible/intangible assets.
Business Report	Assessment	A presentation deck for buyers detailing fair market value, earnings capitalisation, a 3-point sensitivity reality check, serviceability, margin for error, and indicative value range.
Business Assessment Report	Sale	A presentation deck for sellers, mirroring the buyer report but focused on proving the business's value, confirming "bankability" for a purchaser, and structuring a defensible asking price.
Supplementary Assessment Report		A secondary risk report for buyers outlining "Notional Liquidation" and business failure recovery values to determine the absolute worst-case scenario.
Supplementary Assessment Report	Sale	A secondary risk report for sellers outlining notional liquidation values, useful for identifying baseline equity in times of distress, high inflation, or shareholder disputes.

Succession Planning

1. The Succession Quiz (Initial Discovery Questionnaire)

- **Benefits:** This template eases the business owner into the process by prompting them to think about "life after the business" (e.g., hobbies, family time, future income, and mental acuity) before tackling complex financial and legal hurdles.
- **How it helps the business owner:** It combats "Role Identification" (the loss of self-worth or community status upon exiting) by helping them build a clear, exciting vision for their future.
- **How it helps the advisor:** It generates a preliminary baseline readiness report. The advisor can assess the client's timeline, successor options, and financial clarity before the first formal meeting.
- **Suitable for:** Business owners at the very beginning of their succession journey, especially those who may be hesitant or struggling to let go of their business identity.

2. Visual Frameworks & Metaphor Slides (The "Dream Home" Metaphor)

- **Benefits:** This template leverages an "Ascension Diagram" (moving from bottom-left to top-right) and the "Dream Home" metaphor to engage both the logical left brain and the conceptual right brain.
- **How it helps the business owner:** It creates a psychological alignment where participants feel they are "moving upward" and improving. It reframes a threatening transition into a collaborative project, like building a house.
- **How it helps the advisor:** It establishes the advisor as a *facilitator* rather than an expert dictating terms. It provides a non-threatening roadmap to gain agreement on *how* the problem will be solved, bypassing the instinctual "argumentative theory" reactions clients have during conflict.
- **Suitable for:** Multi-stakeholder families or complex transition teams where confirmation bias, conflict, or stress is likely to derail early planning.

3. The Wishes Meeting Template

- **Benefits:** A structured framework for gathering qualitative data around family considerations, financial needs, and successor requirements.
- **How it helps the business owner/successors:** It ensures all voices are heard regarding critical issues like stewardship vs. ownership, fair market compensation, divorce risks, and sibling equity.
- **How it helps the advisor:** It allows the advisor to capture the unique expectations of both the incumbents (parents) and the successors (kids) independently, preventing premature conflict.
- **Suitable for:** The formal discovery phase where specific legal, estate, and emotional "wish lists" must be documented prior to designing the actual transition plan.

4. The Comprehensive Guide & Step-by-Step Logic

- **Benefits:** It grounds the emotional facilitation of succession planning in rigorous global standards, such as ISO 22301 (Risk Mitigation), IFAC (Value Preservation), and OECD principles.
 - **How it helps the business owner:** It ensures their plan is globally defensible, structurally sound, and protects the organization from existential risks like the sudden loss of key personnel.
 - **How it helps the advisor:** It provides a concrete, 6-step implementation methodology and a 5-year lead time ("Rule of 5") framework to pace the engagement appropriately.
 - **Suitable for:** Advisors actively managing the transition and structuring the long-term consulting engagement.
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Practitioners Guide: Step-by-Step Implementation Methodology

To successfully apply this material in practice, follow the 6-step "Dream Home" methodology, which marries psychological metaphors with structural IFAC and ISO logic:

- **Step 1: Initial Discovery (Getting Started)** Direct the client to the digital **Succession Quiz**. Have them answer preliminary questions regarding their exit timeline, business value, and life after business. Generate a private report to assess their readiness before you meet.
- **Step 2: The "Parents' Wish List" Meeting** Just like an architect gathering requirements for a house, host your first formal meeting with the incumbents. Use the **Wishes Meeting** template to capture their financial requirements, estate wishes, and successor expectations.
- **Step 3: The "Kids' Wish List" Meeting** Conduct an identical exercise with the incoming successors. **Crucial:** If there is existing family disharmony, keep this document completely hidden from the parents to prevent premature conflict.
- **Step 4: Concept Drawings (The Concept Meeting)** Bring all stakeholders together. Place the parents' wishes alongside the successors' wishes. Facilitate a discussion on the natural constraints and required compromises to align expectations.
- **Step 5: Final Design and Sign-Off Meeting** Deliver your professional recommendations on business valuation, tax, and legal frameworks. The family reviews the budget, finalizes their "must-haves," and formally signs off on the final transition design.
- **Step 6: Construction Begins (Implementation)** Implement a secure "succession action plan" with assigned tasks. Ensure sensitive tasks are sectioned off from broader staff to maintain confidentiality, per OECD governance principles.

Common Succession Q&A

Q1: How do we ensure the succession plan is financially viable?

A: A rigorous diagnostic analysis must be performed to ensure a "sound business case". It is critical to evaluate if transfer costs and funding requirements for withdrawing parties will debilitate the incoming successors. Independent advisors should assess fair value and tax efficiency.

Q2: Should the successors "own" the assets entirely?

A: This must be deliberately defined by the family. They must decide if assets will be outright "owned" by the recipient, or if the successor is acting in "stewardship" to preserve the asset for future generations. Clarifying the separation of powers is highly recommended by the OECD.

Q3: What happens if an unexpected event disrupts the succession timeline?

A: Under ISO 22301 business continuity standards, you must have a dual-track plan. This includes establishing 'trigger events' that can speed up the plan, as well as an emergency "sudden departure" plan if a successor needs to withdraw due to trauma or life changes.

Q4: Is there enough time to train the successor properly?

A: Global best practice dictates a 5-year lead time. This provides adequate time for transferring vital skills through strategic project assignments and using a 9-Box Grid to continually measure the successor's capabilities against the timeline.

Q5: How do we handle siblings who are receiving disparate financial figures?

A: Transparency is paramount. The methodology and reasons must be thoroughly discussed and agreed to by all parties. Establishing a "Family Constitution" early on ensures objective rules are in place. Tools like a 'Salary Sacrifice' table can help calculate real-world loss of income for siblings who provided care to elderly parents.

Q6: Does the successor's past compensation impact the final transition?

A: Yes. You must evaluate whether previous wages were paid at a "fair market rate". If a successor was chronically underpaid while building the business, the family needs to negotiate whether a discount should be applied to their final purchase price.

Financial Systems Review

1. Template Overview: Benefits, Value, and Suitability

Financial Systems Review (Heli-View)

- **Benefits:** Provides a high-level overview of a company's internal procedures across five core pillars: Revenue, Expenditure, Inventory, I.T Systems, and Payroll. It is designed to uncover "easy wins" without getting bogged down in deep auditing questions.
- **Helps the Business Owner:** Exposes potential system leakages and procedural gaps (e.g., lack of blind cash counting, unchecked user access levels) before they cause significant damage.
- **Helps the Advisor:** Acts as an excellent onboarding tool for new clients to pre-qualify their internal operations, preventing unbilled "job creep" or scope variations in the first year.
- **Suitability:** New clients during the onboarding phase, or existing clients needing a foundational health check. It is perfect for general accountants and advisors who do not have specialized in-house audit divisions.

Financial Systems Report

- **Benefits:** Formalizes the detailed discovery phase by rating specific procedures (e.g., cash handling, staff expenses) as "Good", "Needs Monitoring", or "Urgent".
- **Helps the Business Owner:** Gives them a clear, prioritized roadmap of vulnerabilities and specific "Recommended Actions" to fix their operations.

- **Helps the Advisor:** Provides a structured template for an audit team to document findings and present a professional, actionable report aligned with the original five-pillar framework.
- **Suitability:** Clients whose initial "Heli-View" revealed significant complexities or risks, requiring an audit specialist to dive deeper into system discovery.

Financial Systems Scenario Report

- **Benefits:** Acts as a post-implementation review mechanism to test whether newly designed systems have actually succeeded, grading them as "Pass" or "Failed".
- **Helps the Business Owner:** Verifies that the time and money spent upgrading their systems yielded tangible results and functional safety.
- **Helps the Advisor:** Closes the advisory loop, providing a reason to re-engage with the client at a specified time post-implementation.
- **Suitability:** Clients who have recently completed system upgrades or overhauls and are ready to test their effectiveness.

Systems Before Scale (Slides)

- **Benefits:** Educates stakeholders on systems thinking, flowcharting (nodes and links), system design, and the critical importance of feedback loops.
- **Helps the Business Owner:** Clarifies the difference between a standalone "process" and an interconnected "system". It helps them visualize their operations to identify and remove errors.
- **Helps the Advisor:** Provides a visual, conceptual tool to convince clients to optimize their operations before making aggressive expansion moves.
- **Suitability:** Business owners who are eager to open new branches or acquire competitors but have not yet reviewed or stabilized their internal systems.

2. Step-by-Step Practical Implementation Method

- **Step 1: The Helicopter View (Initial Assessment).** Sit down with the client and run through the *Financial Systems Review*. Ask the high-level questions regarding their revenue, expenditure, inventory, IT, and payroll to identify easy wins or surface-level risks.
- **Step 2: Scope Protection (For New Clients).** If doing this for a new client, use these initial findings to confirm the ongoing engagement scope. This ensures that their messy internal procedures don't lead to unpaid "fee creep" for your firm down the road.
- **Step 3: Detailed Discovery Handoff.** If the Heli-View reveals complex issues, hand the client over to an audit division (internal or external). The general advisor stays out of the granular details, allowing specialists to fill in the blanks.
- **Step 4: Reporting and Recommendations.** The audit team uses the *Financial Systems Report* to grade the specific procedures and present written "Recommended Actions" for the client to implement.

- **Step 5: System Redesign.** Utilize the principles in the *Systems B4 Scale* slides to help the client flowchart new systems using sticky notes (Nodes) and order sequences (Links), ensuring robust feedback loops are built in.
- **Step 6: Post-Implementation Testing.** After a specified timeframe, reconvene using the *Financial Systems Scenario Report*. Grade the newly implemented procedures as "Pass" or "Failed" to determine if further action is needed.

3. Common Q&A

Q1: Why should a business review its systems before expanding?

A: Expanding before fixing internal systems is like "trying to fix the cracks in the garden hose, while you're putting out your house fire." You must get the foundation right before you go big.

Q2: What is the difference between a process and a system?

A: A process is a sequence of actions to produce a consistent component (like building a car engine). A system is a collection of interdependent processes acting as a whole (like assembling all components to make a drivable car).

Q3: What should an advisor do if they don't have an audit background?

A: The advisor should strictly use the "Heli-View" to uncover overarching issues. For detailed discovery, they should partner with an external auditor or a different service line within their practice to handle the deep dive.

Q4: How does this framework protect accounting firms from unbilled work?

A: By using the initial review during the onboarding phase, the firm can identify a client's internal messy procedures upfront. This prevents the firm from absorbing unbilled time ("job creep") caused by the client's internal inefficiencies.

Q5: What are the most important elements to include when designing a new system?

A: The two most critical aspects are the *Design* (the correct architecture and sequence of resources) and the *Feedback Loop* (which is essential for identifying and removing errors).

Q6: What is the purpose of the Scenario Report?

A: It is used after system recommendations have been implemented. An auditor jumps back in to test if the new system succeeded ("Pass") or if further corrections are still required ("Failed").

People Power

1. Strategic Feedback Surveys (Client, Supplier, Team)

Overview: This suite of templates provides frameworks for gathering candid feedback from key stakeholders.

- **Benefits:** Utilizes open-ended, conversational questions to bypass "coded language" and polite but unhelpful answers. It actively identifies workflow bottlenecks, internal communication breakdowns, and untapped business opportunities.
- **How it helps the Business Owner:** Highlights blind spots in service delivery and internal culture, allowing the owner to adapt proactively before clients leave or staff resign.
- **How it helps the Advisor:** Yields high-quality, objective data that forms the foundation of a strategic consulting roadmap. It helps advisors pinpoint exactly where a business is leaking value.
- **Suitable For:** Established businesses seeking to benchmark performance, diagnose sudden drops in retention, or improve overall stakeholder engagement.
- **Step-by-step Application:**
 1. **Preparation:** Do not use rigid, lengthy scripts. Focus on securing permission by sounding genuinely interested.
 2. **Engagement:** Call the stakeholder (e.g., "The reason for my call is to see if you'd be open to giving us some honest feedback...").
 3. **Execution:** Ask open-ended questions like, "What are your expectations regarding how we deliver?" or "Where are the workflow bottlenecks?"
 4. **Follow-up:** Show the participant you've acted on their input to build long-term trust.

2. Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) Toolkit

Overview: Includes the "Notice of PIP Meeting," the "PIP Template," and the "Managing Poor Performance" guide.

- **Benefits:** Provides a formal, forward-looking, and legally structured framework to resolve underperformance, distinguishing it from misconduct.
- **How it helps the Business Owner:** Protects the employer by ensuring fair process (good faith) and clear documentation, mitigating the risk of unfair dismissal or stress-related claims.
- **How it helps the Advisor:** Allows the advisor to impartially coach the owner through difficult HR conversations, ensuring emotions are removed and compliance is maintained.
- **Suitable For:** Employers managing staff who fail to meet job standards despite prior informal coaching and support.
- **Step-by-step Application:**
 1. **Notification:** Send the "Notice of PIP Meeting," clearly stating the performance gaps and advising the employee to bring a support person.
 2. **Consultation:** Hold the meeting to discuss concerns and review the draft PIP, allowing the employee to provide feedback.
 3. **Implementation:** Complete the PIP template detailing the performance gap, specific actions required, support/training provided, and the timeline for improvement.

4. **Review:** Meet at scheduled intervals (e.g., 30, 60, 90 days) to assess milestones and decide if formal warnings are required.

3. Remuneration & Incentive Models

Overview: Features the "Profit Share Agreement," "Incentive Points Explained," and the "Profit Share Model".

- **Benefits:** Aligns employee rewards with business success. The Profit Share model distributes a percentage of surplus funds after attributed costs, while the Points system drives inter-coaching and peer support.
- **How it helps the Business Owner:** Encourages team members to think laterally about increasing sales or reducing costs. It uses a "wash-up" facility (retaining a percentage of bonuses until year-end) to maintain safe cash flow.
- **How it helps the Advisor:** Gives the advisor a tangible tool to mathematically demonstrate the ROI of increased productivity, helping the client transition from fixed-wage mindsets to performance-based cultures.
- **Suitable For:** Businesses with measurable outputs (Points System) or project-based profitability where staff can directly influence margins (Profit Share).
- **Step-by-step Application:**
 1. **Select the Model:** Determine if the team influences margins (Profit Share) or repeatable output (Incentives/Points).
 2. **Define Thresholds & Rules:** Use the Profit Share Model spreadsheet to establish gross margin thresholds and bonus splits.
 3. **Formalize:** Execute the legal Profit Share Agreement, ensuring criteria like a minimum of 12 months' employment are clear.
 4. **Administer:** Track results clearly, deduct appropriate taxes, and hold back "wash-up" funds until the final quarter.

4. Experiential Team Building (Paper & Spaghetti Towers)

Overview: Physical workshop tasks that require teams to build structures using limited resources under time constraints.

- **Benefits:** Acts as a behavioral mirror. It visually demonstrates whether a team is outcome-oriented or process-driven, and highlights how personalities interact under pressure.
- **How it helps the Business Owner:** Flushes out true team dynamics and leadership styles in a low-risk environment, proving that "failing to plan is planning to fail".
- **How it helps the Advisor:** Provides a high-impact workshop exercise. The advisor uses the "Paper Tower Model" spreadsheet to calculate actual profit/loss of the team's effort, driving home the financial impact of poor teamwork.
- **Suitable For:** Team workshops, strategic retreats, or organizations suffering from poor internal communication.

- **Step-by-step Application:**
 1. **Set the Rules:** Issue materials (e.g., 20 sheets of paper, or 20 spaghetti sticks/marshmallow) and state constraints (no prefabrication).
 2. **Plan and Execute:** Give 20 minutes to plan, followed immediately by 10 minutes to build.
 3. **Measure:** Calculate the profit using height achieved minus the cost of materials and time taken.
 4. **Debrief:** Use the "Review Questions" to ask, "Did anybody complete a financial calculation prior to building?" and map the experience to workplace habits.

5. Team Dynamics & Hiring Suite

Overview: Encompasses "Hiring Winners", "Team CANOE Review", and Enneagram Coping materials.

- **Benefits:** Shifts hiring from gut-feeling to an objective assessment of the 'Big Five' traits (Conscientiousness, Agreeableness, Neuroticism, Openness, Extraversion) and maps Enneagram coping styles (Competency, Positive Outlook, Intensity).
- **How it helps the Business Owner:** Prevents hiring mistakes by checking if candidates have complementary traits to the existing team, reducing disruptive behaviors.
- **How it helps the Advisor:** Allows the advisor to conduct 360-degree audits of the team, mapping out exactly where communication gaps exist and advising on structural reorganization.
- **Suitable For:** Scaling businesses, leaders frustrated with team conflict, or businesses looking to refine their recruitment process.
- **Step-by-step Application:**
 1. **Assess the Current Team:** Have staff complete the 360-degree CANOE review to identify trait gaps.
 2. **Define the Role:** Map the daily tasks to determine if you need a specialist or utility player.
 3. **Grade Applicants:** Use a 3-stage process (Feel, Know, Test) to evaluate candidates, testing them in different environments (e.g., shifting meeting 3 to a cafe).
 4. **Orient:** Pair the new hire with a buddy trained in global and local presentation frameworks.

6. Cafe Turnaround Behaviours

- **Purpose:** To provide structural considerations and communication scripts designed to improve customer engagement and handle complaints in a hospitality setting.

- How it helps the business owner: It gives them actionable, scenario-based scripts for their staff (e.g., handling a queue vs. a single customer) to improve the customer experience and increase upselling.
- How it helps the advisor: It serves as a practical, ready-made training tool for the advisor to run role-play sessions and facilitate behavioral change among the client's frontline team.
- Appropriate Indicators: A hospitality client is suffering from poor customer service, low average transaction values (lack of upselling), or negative online reviews.

7. Phone Techniques

- Purpose: A training presentation on standardized phone etiquette, shaping business culture, and handling difficult customers using the "H.E.A.T" method.
- How it helps the business owner: It establishes a minimum communication standard for the team, empowering them to manage "hotheads" effectively and create a memorable customer experience.
- How it helps the advisor: It provides a ready-to-deliver training session, complete with role-play exercises, to immediately add value to a client's frontline staff.
- Appropriate Indicators: The business has a high rate of customer complaints over the phone, inconsistent team greetings, or frontline staff struggling with angry callers.

Common Q&A

Q: How do I choose between a profit-share and a points-based incentive? A: Use profit-sharing when employees can actively influence the sale price or margin (e.g., a sales team). If the team cannot affect profitability but performs highly repeatable tasks, an output-based points program is more effective.

Q: Why should we use the CANOE model instead of standard interviews? A: People often lie or bend their perspectives in standard interviews. CANOE focuses on observable traits rather than temperament. By asking for specific anecdotes (e.g., "Give me an idea of when you last prepared for something you love"), you can test actual behaviors like Conscientiousness.

Q: What makes a Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) legally robust? A: It must be an objective, forward-looking process executed in good faith. It requires providing clear expectations, offering practical solutions and training, allowing a realistic timeframe, and distinguishing performance gaps from disciplinary misconduct.

Q: How do I ensure I get honest responses from the Client or Supplier Surveys? A: Avoid long, scripted checklists. Focus on building the relationship eyeball-to-eyeball or over the phone. You must establish permission, keep questions open-ended, and actively demonstrate later that you have acted on their input.

Q: Why use experiential tasks like the Paper Tower? A: These tasks force teams out of their standard workflow and expose natural dynamics. It allows facilitators to observe if the team appointed a timekeeper, accurately defined the objective, or assessed options without bias, providing a mirror to how they operate daily.

Q: How do I manage an employee whose poor performance is linked to a "Disruptive" Enneagram type? A: Identify their coping style. For example, if they are a 'Challenger' (Type 8), they cope with intensity. Manage them by matching their energy but staying focused on the issue, not the person, and avoiding telling them to "calm down".

Raising Capital

1. The Startup Pitch Deck Template

Benefits: This template provides a structured visual and narrative flow for pitching a business to investors, ensuring all critical questions are answered concisely.

How it helps the business owner: It forces the founder to distill their business model, competitive advantage, and financial needs into a clear, digestible format, preventing them from overwhelming investors with unnecessary details.

How it helps the advisor: Advisors can use this framework to guide founders through defining their "Status Quo," "Problem," and "Solution," ensuring the narrative is investor-ready.

Suitable for: Early-stage startups and entrepreneurs seeking seed capital, venture capital, or angel investment.

Step-by-Step Method:

1. **Executive Summary:** State exactly what funding is required, the purpose of the funds, year 3 revenue/profit targets, and your unique position.
2. **Define the Problem & Solution:** Outline the global status quo, specify the local problem for different user levels, and present your solution's three main advantages.
3. **Analyze the Market & Competition:** Identify key competitors, explain why they fail to solve the problem, and highlight your single point of difference. Quantify the total potential market users.
4. **Detail the Business Model & Traction:** Explain how you charge for the product (e.g., by the pack, by the box, store support) and outline historical business milestones and revenue achieved to date.

5. **The "Ask" (Use of Funds):** Present the target metrics for scaling and explicitly detail how the requested funds will be utilized (e.g., recruiting sales/production staff).

2. The Venture Capital Investment Cycle Template

Benefits: This framework breaks down the venture capital relationship into three manageable phases: Pre-investment, Post-investment, and Exit.

How it helps the business owner: It provides a realistic roadmap of what working with institutional capital looks like, removing the "illusion of speed" and preparing them for a long-term partnership.

How it helps the advisor: Advisors can use this to set client expectations regarding valuation control, trust-building, and the eventual need to plan an exit strategy.

Suitable for: High-growth startups targeting institutional venture capital.

Step-by-Step Method:

1. **Pre-investment:** Identify target investors based on stage and industry, deliver a formal pitch, and negotiate the term sheet to establish valuation and control.
2. **Post-investment:** Focus on managing the relationship with the VC through effective communication, mutual trust, and establishing objectivity.
3. **Exit Phase:** Establish a timely and harmonious exit strategy (e.g., IPO or sale) that aligns with the VC's return expectations.

3. The Six Procedural Hurdles of Fundraising Template

Benefits: It maps out the specific 6-month procedural funnel required to secure capital, acknowledging that skipping steps often leads to failure.

How it helps the business owner: It demystifies the fundraising timeline, helping founders understand that money does not change hands after a single meeting.

How it helps the advisor: It allows the advisor to track a client's fundraising pipeline systematically and prepare them for specific milestones, such as transitioning from the first meeting to the second.

Suitable for: Founders engaging in active market outreach for funding.

Step-by-Step Method:

1. **Warm Introduction:** Secure an initial contact with the VC firm.
2. **Pitch Deck Submission:** Send the formal business overview via email.
3. **Initial Screen:** Conduct a preliminary phone conversation to gauge investor interest.
4. **First Meeting:** Present a deep dive into the business model and the team.
5. **Second Meeting:** Provide granular data (e.g., Lifetime Value/Customer Acquisition Cost) for a larger partner group or technical review.
6. **Deal Structuring:** Finalize the approval of fundraising documents and transfer the cash.

4. The 90-Day Due Diligence Preparation Plan Template

Benefits: It converts an overwhelming legal, financial, and tax compliance burden into a structured, chronological project plan.

How it helps the business owner: It builds investor confidence and speeds up deal closures by ensuring the company is "investor-ready" well before a term sheet is signed.

How it helps the advisor: It provides a strict timeline to project-manage the client's internal audits, resolving issues like unassigned Intellectual Property (IP) or revenue mismatches.

Suitable for: Startups planning an upcoming funding round (3 to 6 months away) who need to resolve existing compliance gaps.

Step-by-Step Method:

1. **Month 1 (Days 1-30) - Audit and Assess:** Conduct an internal compliance health check, list pending statutory filings, review material contracts, and confirm IP ownership/assignment.
2. **Month 2 (Days 31-60) - Organize and Fix:** Reconcile financial statements with GST and bank records, execute missing agreements (e.g., founder vesting, IP assignment), and resolve any pending tax notices.
3. **Month 3 (Days 61-90) - Package and Present:** Set up a Virtual Data Room with 10 organized folders (Corporate, Cap Table, Financial, Tax, Legal, HR, IP, Tech, Commercial, Insurance), prepare financial projections, and brief customer references.

5. Kotter's 8-Step Change Management Process Template

Benefits: It provides a pragmatic, visionary approach to implementing strategic transformations without failing due to poor execution.

How it helps the business owner: It guides leadership through the difficult phases of restructuring, ensuring new processes are culturally anchored and sustainable.

How it helps the advisor: It gives the advisor a step-by-step consulting framework to help clients scale, pivot, or adapt to market pressures.

Suitable for: Established businesses needing to implement major organizational changes.

Step-by-Step Method:

1. Create a sense of urgency (Ein Gefühl für Dringlichkeit erzeugen).
2. Build a guiding coalition (Eine Führungskolition aufbauen).
3. Develop vision and strategy (Vision und Strategie entwickeln).
4. Communicate the change vision (Die Vision des Wandels kommunizieren).
5. Empower employees on a broad basis (Mitarbeiter auf breiter Basis befähigen).
6. Generate quick wins (Schnelle Erfolge erzielen).
7. Consolidate gains and produce more change (Erfolge konsolidieren und weitere Veränderungen einleiten).
8. Anchor new approaches in the corporate culture (Neue Ansätze in der Kultur verankern).

6. The Six Patterns of Entrepreneurship Assessment Template

Benefits: It broadens the definition of entrepreneurship beyond Silicon Valley, allowing individuals to evaluate risk, control, and lifestyle tradeoffs across different business models.

How it helps the business owner: It helps founders match their personal risk appetite and "Rich vs. Royal" goals (wealth vs. control) to the right business path.

How it helps the advisor: Advisors can use this to steer clients toward suitable financing and operational structures based on their actual life goals and desired work/life balance.

Suitable for: Aspiring entrepreneurs, MBA graduates, and family business successors.

Step-by-Step Method:

1. **Evaluate Lifestyle and Control Goals:** Assess the desire for massive wealth ("Rich") versus retaining decision-making control ("Royal").
 2. **Select the Pattern:** Choose between VC-backed technology, cool branded consumer products, "boring and basic" operations, franchisee models, search funds (acquisition), or family business takeovers.
 3. **Align Capital and Risk:** Determine if the path requires VC funding (high risk, sacrificing control) or if it can be bootstrapped, debt-financed, or funded via a search fund model (retaining more control).
-

5 Common Q&A

Q1: How long does the due diligence process typically take once a term sheet is signed?

A: Due diligence is a structured investigation that typically takes between 2 to 8 weeks depending on the funding stage. Angel/Pre-Seed rounds take 1 to 2 weeks, Seed rounds take 2 to 4 weeks, Series A takes 4 to 6 weeks, and Series B+ can take 6 to 8 weeks.

Q2: What is the most common dealbreaker found during IP due diligence?

A: A major red flag is when founders or developers have not formally assigned their pre-incorporation intellectual property (code, designs, concepts) to the company. Investors require explicit IP assignment agreements.

Q3: What is the "Rich vs. Royal" dilemma in entrepreneurship?

A: It refers to the tradeoff founders face between maximizing wealth ("Rich") and maintaining control of the business ("Royal"). Raising VC funding usually sacrifices "royal" security for potential riches, whereas bootstrapping a "boring and basic" business allows the founder to maintain high control.

Q4: What is a "Search Fund" or "Entrepreneurship Through Acquisition" (ETA)?

A: It is a path where an entrepreneur raises capital to acquire an existing small-to-medium business rather than starting one from scratch. This model bypasses the riskiest early stages of a startup because the acquired business is already a cash-generating going concern.

Q5: What metrics do investors look for during financial due diligence?

A: Investors verify Monthly Recurring Revenue (MRR), Customer Acquisition Cost (CAC), a Lifetime Value (LTV) to CAC ratio of 3x or higher, gross margin trends, churn rate, and cash burn rate.

Ratio Analysis

Common Size Trend Analysis & Ratio Analysis: An Educational Guide

Effective business management relies heavily on accurate data interpretation. The provided materials consist of a spreadsheet template for quantitative analysis and a slide deck presentation outlining the strategic framework for data interpretation. Together, they help ensure that business reporting compares "apples with apples".

1. Common Size Trend Analysis (Spreadsheet Template)

Benefits of the Template This template allows businesses to input up to six years of financial data to automatically generate "Common Size" and trend percentage variations. By converting raw dollar amounts into percentages (e.g., Profit & Loss items as a percentage of Total Sales, and Balance Sheet items as a percentage of Total Assets), the template removes the distortion of pure revenue growth, allowing for an accurate view of operational efficiency. It also automatically calculates key formulas across four main categories: Activity, Profitability, Liquidity, and Leverage.

How it Helps the Business Owner It prevents owners from falling victim to "confirmation bias". For example, a business owner might think they are doing better simply because they started the year with higher cash reserves and stock. The Common Size Analysis helps them measure their true 'Start' and 'Finish' positions each year, rather than just looking at overall growth.

How it Helps the Advisor It provides a standardized, automated tool to quickly process a client's historical data. Because all formulas are clearly defined on the "Ratios" tab (such as calculating "Return on Equity" as $\text{Net Profit} / \text{Total Equity}$), the advisor can easily verify the calculations and use the resulting trends to facilitate high-level advisory conversations.

Who it is Suitable For This template is suitable for established businesses that have accumulated multiple years of financial data and wish to evaluate their year-over-year operational trends, or for

advisors managing the "Compilation/Verification" and "Assimilation" stages of business management.

Step-by-Step Method in Practice

1. **Data Compilation:** Gather the client's verified Profit & Loss and Balance Sheet actuals for the desired number of years (up to 6).
 2. **Data Entry:** Insert the raw financial figures into the clear/orange boxes on the "Profit & Loss" and "Balance Sheet" tabs.
 3. **Review Common Size Output:** Analyze the automated common size percentages. Check how individual expenses compare to Total Sales, and how asset/liability classes compare to Total Assets.
 4. **Analyze Ratio Trends:** Navigate to the "Ratios" tab to review Activity Ratios (like Debtors Days on Hand), Profitability Ratios (like Gross Margin), Liquidity Ratios, and Leverage Ratios.
 5. **Identify Variances:** Look for massive percentage changes in the "Trend" columns to identify areas requiring deeper investigation.
-

2. Ratio Analysis Presentation (Slide Deck)

Benefits of the Template This presentation outlines the theoretical framework behind ratio analysis. It introduces the "5 steps in the Advisory staircase" (Compilation/Verification, Assimilation, Interpretation, Application, and Observation) and establishes the rules for when data is—and isn't—relevant for comparison.

How it Helps the Business Owner It helps owners understand the "why" behind the numbers. It educates them on the importance of "Knowing Thyself First"—meaning they must capture internal business assumptions and build a predictive revenue model before worrying about external industry benchmarks.

How it Helps the Advisor It serves as an excellent visual aid for client meetings to set ground rules for financial interpretation. It helps the advisor steer the client away from making "rookie mistakes," such as purchasing external benchmark data without first standardizing their own internal performance data.

Who is Suitable For Advisors conducting strategic planning or financial review sessions with business owners who need to understand how to correctly interpret and apply their business data.

Step-by-Step Method in Practice

1. **Establish the Framework:** Present the 5 components of business management to outline the journey from data collection to observation.

2. **Define Internal Baselines:** Work with the client to develop a predictive scenario model validated by actual performance data before looking at outside competitors.
3. **Filter Out Distortions:** Review current ratios to ensure they aren't skewed by one-off situations (like a massive, unpaid invoice inflating Debtors Days on Hand) or fundamentally different seasonal periods.
4. **Interrogate Benchmarks:** If the client wishes to compare their business against external data, use the presentation's checklist to interrogate the source: Ask about sample size, the calculation methods used, and geographical or seasonal influences.

Common Q&A

Q1: What are the 5 components of business management in the advisory staircase?

A: The five steps are Compilation/Verification, Assimilation, Interpretation, Application, and Observation.

Q2: Why should I convert my P&L and Balance Sheet into a "Common Size" format?

A: If you only compare year-on-year data without adjusting for your previous year's performance, you might confuse external advantages (like starting a year with extra cash reserves) for management success. Common sizing—dividing P&L items by Total Sales and Balance Sheet items by Total Assets—measures both your 'Start' and 'Finish' positions accurately.

Q3: When should I avoid comparing historical ratios for my own business?

A: You should avoid comparisons if the ratios were calculated using different methods across different periods, if a massive one-off situation distorted the data for a given period, or if you are comparing fundamentally different time frames (e.g., peak season vs. low season).

Q4: What is the "rookie mistake" when it comes to benchmarking data?

A: The rookie mistake is rushing to purchase external benchmark data without first capturing and quantifying internal business assumptions to create standardized internal benchmarks.

Q5: What questions should I ask before trusting external benchmark data?

A: You must ensure you are comparing "apples with apples." Ask how many businesses the data covers, if the businesses are of a similar size, how old the data is, if the figures provide comprehensive info on calculation methods, and if there are geographical or seasonal factors influencing the data.

Q6: How does the template calculate "Return on Assets" and "Return on Equity"?

A: According to the spreadsheet formulas, Return on Assets is calculated as $(\text{Net Profit} + \text{Bank Interest} + \text{Finance Interest}) / \text{Total Assets}$. Return on Equity is calculated as $\text{Net Profit} / \text{Total Equity}$.

Stock Policies

The Weighted Average Inventory (Stock Purchasing) Model.

Benefits of the Model

This framework provides a data-driven, systematic approach to inventory management. By balancing product velocity, profit margins, and cash liquidity, it removes the guesswork from purchasing decisions. The model ensures capital is not trapped in low-performing or "singular" items while protecting against stockouts of high-volume, highly profitable favorites.

How it Helps the Business Owner

For a business owner, cash flow is king. This framework helps owners protect their operational cash flow by integrating a mandatory "Financial Check" before any stock is ordered. It prevents overstocking by mathematically calculating exact re-order minimums based on actual sales and supplier lead times. Ultimately, it maximizes Return on Investment (ROI) by ensuring working capital is deployed only toward inventory that objectively performs well.

How it Helps the Advisor

For an advisor or consultant, this framework provides a structured, objective tool to evaluate a client's inventory health. It bridges the gap between operational metrics (like "days on hand") and financial metrics (like the "Quick Ratio"). This allows the advisor to elevate the conversation from simple supply-chain management to holistic business liquidity, risk assessment, and seasonal capital expenditure planning.

Who it is Suitable For

This model is highly suitable for retailers, wholesalers, e-commerce brands, and any inventory-heavy business. Because the framework includes strategic "exceptions" for different product types, it is particularly useful for businesses that carry a mix of high-volume commodities and unique, singular, or exotic items.

Using the Framework in Practice: Step-by-Step Methods

Step 1. Review Past Sales Reports & Collate Into Matrix

- The Action: Gather past sales data to determine which units yield the best margin, sell in the highest volumes, move the quickest, and carry the least unit cost risk.
- The Weighting: Assign a point weighting to each of these categories to generate a priority ranking or "Weighted Average" for your products.
- The Exceptions:
 - *For imported/exotic/singular items:* Ignore the 'Volume' weighting entirely. Place your emphasis on the 'Days on Hand' metric.
 - *For bulk/high-quantity items:* Ignore the 'Days on Hand' weighting. Heavily weight the 'Volume' sold (or sales as a % of stock units purchased), alongside 'Margin' and 'Unit Cost Risk'.

Step 2. Stock Check

- The Action: Compare your highest-ranking "Weighted Average" products against your actual physical stock holdings. Crucial: You must include incoming units currently in transit from suppliers.
- Calculate Re-order Minimum: Assess your average daily units sold against the supplier's lead time (time taken to arrive).
 - *Formula:* Daily Average Sales × Days to Arrive = Re-order Minimum.
 - *Example:* If you sell 3 items per day and it takes 5 days for the supplier to deliver, your absolute re-order minimum is 15 units.

Step 3. Financial Check

- The Action: Before getting the checkbook out, review the company's financial position.
- The Metrics: Calculate the Quick Ratio (Liquidity) to assess your total financial exposure.
- The Forecast: Cross-reference this stock purchase against the operational needs of the business, upcoming Capital Expenditure (Capex) forecasts, and your seasonally adjusted Sales & Expenses forecast.

Step 4. Order Stock

- The Action: Execute the purchase order confidently, knowing the stock is mathematically required and financially viable.

Common Q&A

Q1: What is the purpose of the Weighted Average?

A: It provides an objective, data-driven ranking of your inventory by synthesizing margin, volume, speed of sale, and unit cost risk into a single score.

Q2: How do I handle unique, high-value, or imported items in the matrix?

A: Because these items are "singular by nature," they won't have high volume. The framework instructs you to ignore the 'Volume' weighting and instead place heavy emphasis on the 'Days on Hand' figure.

Q3: How exactly do I calculate when to re-order?

A: Multiply your "average daily units sold" by the number of days the product takes to arrive from the supplier. This number becomes your re-order minimum.

Q4: Should I count stock that hasn't arrived yet?

A: Yes. When comparing your weighted average results against current stock, you must always include incoming units that are in transit.

Q5: Why is the Financial Check Step necessary if I know I need the stock?

A: Because operational needs and liquidity (Quick Ratio) take precedence. Even if stock is low, evaluating your cash position, upcoming Capex, and seasonal expense forecasts ensures you don't over-expose the business financially to buy inventory.

Q6: What if my sales are highly seasonal?

A: During Step 3, the framework requires you to view your Sales & Expenses forecast as "seasonally adjusted" so you aren't ordering based on peak-season daily averages during a slow period.

Governance Tools

The following summary relates to content stored in the Governance / Board Pack section of Advisor-e. This content is designed to help advisors secure advisory engagements with new and existing clients. The content is a combination of FACILITATION, EDUCATION & ADVICE and therefore, is better suited to

advisors who have previous experience in running client meetings without supervision and are confident to deliver complex business concepts.

1. 6 Hats Thinking

- Purpose: A collaborative framework designed by Edward De Bono to guide "parallel thinking" and overcome argumentative theory and confirmation bias. It uses different "hats" to focus discussions on logic, emotion, caution, optimism, creativity, and organization.
- How it helps the business owner: It aligns the team to focus on the same topic from the same perspective simultaneously, increasing the effectiveness of planning sessions tenfold and preventing well-meaning individuals from working at cross purposes.
- How it helps the advisor: It provides a structured, guided tool to facilitate client discussions, ensuring everyone contributes and discussions remain focused and productive.
- Indicators for use: The client indicates a need to improve their "decision quality" rather than rule adherence, or meetings frequently derail due to conflicting problem-solving approaches.

2. Agenda & Notes

- Purpose: A simple, recurring meeting template to allocate time for specific topics, track action plan progress, and note key takeaways.
- How it helps the business owner: Allows leaders to routinely check financial performance, assess what has gone well or less well, and formalize the main lessons from the meeting.
- How it helps the advisor: Offers a straightforward mechanism for holding clients accountable during regular touchpoints by structuring review sessions.
- Indicators for use: The client struggles with tracking task status between meetings, or their basic management meetings lack a consistent feedback loop.

3. Annual Board Plan

- Purpose: A yearly matrix mapping out strategic meeting topics (e.g., Scenario Planning, CEO Performance Review, Budgets) month-by-month, alongside required reports and board pack requirements.
- How it helps the business owner: Ensures that no critical element of strategic governance or compliance is missed over the financial year.
- How it helps the advisor: Provides a roadmap to assist the client in transitioning from ad-hoc meetings to a structured, professional governance rhythm.

- Indicators for use: The client suffers from a lack of formal protocols, or their board needs to improve "rule adherence and accountability".

4. Board Member Conduct

- Purpose: A framework to identify a team's functioning levels, highlight boardroom manipulation tactics (like the "Bully" or "Turtle Mentality"), and establish a firm code of conduct.
- How it helps the business owner: Promotes self-awareness and helps directors check their egos, align with common goals, and embrace healthy brainstorming and respect.
- How it helps the advisor: Gives the advisor an objective tool to address toxic boardroom dynamics, implement "safe words" to manage conduct, and foster authentic contribution.
- Indicators for use: The board suffers from "Poor Member Conduct," internal drama, manipulation, or entrenched ego-driven conflicts.

5. Board Pack Tables

- Purpose: A checklist designed to track meeting agendas, previous minutes, CEO/Financial reports, and major correspondence, ensuring materials are read and understood.
- How it helps the business owner: Enforces accountability for meeting preparation, ensuring directors don't waste time reading during the session.
- How it helps the advisor: Helps establish a pre-meeting preparation discipline for clients moving toward formal governance.
- Indicators for use: The client complains about unprepared directors, or the business lacks reliable protocols for distributing and reviewing board papers.

6. BoardPack.Agenda

- Purpose: A highly detailed board meeting agenda breaking down exactly how many minutes are allocated to each item (e.g., PI Notifications, Matters Arising, CEO Report).
- How it helps the business owner: Professionalizes the board meeting structure and keeps discussions strictly within the total allocated time.
- How it helps the advisor: Allows the advisor to teach the client (or Chair) how to effectively corral meeting time and guide discussions efficiently.
- Indicators for use: The client's meetings regularly run over time, or they are just beginning to formalize board meeting procedures and lack protocols.

7. BoardPack.WP Guide (White Paper Guidelines)

- Purpose: A structural guide for writing white papers, outlining how to format executive summaries, define the problem/opportunity, provide historical context, suggest solutions, and measure benefits.
- How it helps the business owner: Helps them clearly articulate business cases, secure vendor agreements, or pitch strategic solutions supported by feasibility data.
- How it helps the advisor: Provides a tool to help the client clarify their thinking and draft sound strategic proposals.
- Indicators for use: The client needs to improve decision quality and needs to present well-researched, feasible solutions or alternatives to the board.

8. Conflicts of Interest Disclosure

- Purpose: A legal tracking template for directors to declare outside financial interests, directorships, or relationships with suppliers.
- How it helps the business owner: Safeguards the company from biased decision-making and ensures compliance by formally documenting potential conflicts.
- How it helps the advisor: Facilitates the implementation of essential risk management and compliance procedures within the client's board.
- Indicators for use: The client lacks formal board protocols, or they are onboarding new directors to a formal board.

9. Governance Introduction

- Purpose: An educational presentation explaining the pillars of governance, the difference between an advisory board and a board of directors, and the basics of CEO reporting.
- How it helps the business owner: Demystifies governance concepts, helping them decide if they need an advisory board (as a stepping stone) or a formal board of directors.
- How it helps the advisor: Serves as a perfect onboarding or pitching tool to help clients understand what governance is, and the systems required for business success.
- Indicators for use: The client states "We need to improve our Governance" focusing on adherence and accountability, but currently has little to no formal understanding of the subject.

10. Governance Playsheet

- Purpose: A diagnostic map that guides users to the correct framework depending on the client's specific governance problems (Decision Quality vs. Adherence).
- How it helps the business owner: Ensures their core problem is diagnosed correctly so that the interventions applied actually solve their underlying issues.

- How it helps the advisor: Acts as an operational flowchart, visually directing the advisor to deploy tools like 6 Hats, White Papers, or Board Plans based on client feedback.
- Indicators for use: To be used internally by the advisor when first assessing a client's need to improve governance or if a client shows signs that management is too ineffective for governance to begin.

11. Leadership Review

- Purpose: A self-reflection questionnaire examining leadership style, cultural alignment (creativity vs. discipline), and inclusivity.
- How it helps the business owner: Encourages deep introspection about how their ego and personal traits influence team diversity, meetings, and business culture.
- How it helps the advisor: Opens up strategic coaching conversations with the business owner regarding their management style and handling of conflict.
- Indicators for use: The client struggles with staff retention, low team morale, lacks diversity in thought, or insists on being right over finding the best solution.

12. Quality Decisions

- Purpose: A comprehensive training presentation exploring common "psyche errors" (like optimism bias and confirmation bias), how to properly interpret data (causation vs. correlation), and how to create frameworks for robust testing.
- How it helps the business owner: Teaches them to avoid relying on faulty memory or bias, enabling them to test assumptions through methods like double-blind surveys, and ultimately turning quality decision-making into a habit.
- How it helps the advisor: Allows the advisor to deeply educate clients on statistical interpretation (common vs. special causes) and the psychological pitfalls of business expansion.
- Indicators for use: The client's business is experiencing complex growth phases, they regularly misinterpret feedback data, or they need structured mechanisms to evaluate "quality decisions".

13. Resolutions

- Purpose: Formal legal templates to document board votes on major actions, such as purchasing a helicopter or private jet, launching a company, paying dividends, or raising capital.
- How it helps the business owner: Keeps the company legally compliant by securing signed proof of unanimous or majority authorization for significant financial events.
- How it helps the advisor: Provides pre-formatted language to help clients efficiently execute required corporate documentation.

- Indicators for use: The client operates a formal board and is preparing to authorize high-stakes financial movements, capital raises, or major asset acquisitions.

14. EF.Risk Mgt Cover

- Purpose: A formal 5-step risk management process and visual matrix designed to help teams establish context, identify, evaluate, and determine strategies for business risks.
- How it helps the business owner: Enables them to systematically assess risks based on probability (likelihood) and consequence (loss). It helps them apply targeted strategies—such as reducing, avoiding, accepting, or transferring the risk to a third party—and formulate concrete contingency and disaster recovery plans.
- How it helps the advisor: Provides a structured framework to guide clients through brainstorming and evaluating risks. It allows the advisor to tie risks back to the client's strategic plan or SWOT analysis and hold them accountable by developing an action plan detailing the task, who is responsible, and when it will be completed.
- Indicators for use: The client needs to develop contingency or disaster recovery plans, or they require a structured way to evaluate and mitigate emerging threats and liabilities based on their potential impact.